

FOREWORD BY D. NGURE

THE GOD FACTOR



DISCOVERING PURPOSE, POWER, AND
POSSIBILITY THROUGH THE LIVES OF
BIBLICAL HEROES



GRACEPATH NETWORK

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THE GOD FACTOR

Discovering the Divine Life Within You

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Introduction

Born from Earth, Filled with Heaven

There is a question that has echoed through the ages, crossing cultures, civilizations, and generations:

Who am I?

It is a question every person must eventually face. Some seek the answer in education. Others look for it in wealth, achievements, relationships, careers, or social status. Yet despite all the advances of human civilization, countless people still struggle with a sense of emptiness, uncertainty, and insignificance.

Why?

Because the answer to who we are cannot be found merely in what we do. It cannot be discovered in the opinions of others. It cannot be measured by the balance in a bank account, the title before our name, or the possessions we accumulate throughout life.

The answer lies deeper.

It lies in understanding how and why we were created.

The Bible presents a remarkable account of man's origin. Unlike the rest of creation, man was not brought into existence through a simple command. When God created light, He spoke. When He created the stars, He spoke. When He created the oceans, mountains, animals, and birds, He spoke.

But when God created man, something extraordinary happened.

Genesis 2:7 tells us:

"And the Lord God formed man of the dust of the ground, and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living being."

This single verse reveals a profound truth about humanity.

Man is both earthly and heavenly.

His body came from the dust of the earth, but his life came from the breath of God.

Within every human being exists a connection to something greater than the natural world. There is a divine imprint, a God-given capacity that separates man from every other creature. While animals operate

primarily through instinct, man was created for relationship with God. He was designed to hear God's voice, reflect God's nature, and fulfil God's purpose.

Yet many people live their entire lives without discovering this truth.

They know what they do, but not who they are.

They understand their weaknesses but remain unaware of their potential.

They recognize their circumstances but fail to recognize the God-given greatness placed within them.

As a result, they live far below the life God intended.

They become prisoners of fear.

Prisoners of doubt.

Prisoners of limitations.

Prisoners of the opinions of others.

They allow their environment to define them rather than allowing God's truth to shape their identity.

This has been humanity's struggle from the very beginning.

When Adam and Eve sinned in the Garden of Eden, something more than disobedience occurred. Sin

damaged man's perception of himself and his relationship with God. The confidence, authority, and fellowship that humanity once enjoyed became clouded by fear, shame, and separation.

Instead of seeing themselves through God's eyes, people began seeing themselves through the lens of failure and limitation.

The effects of this spiritual blindness can still be seen today.

Many individuals measure their worth by their background.

Some believe they can never rise above the family they came from.

Others allow poverty to define them.

Some are controlled by painful experiences from their past.

Others are trapped by negative words spoken over them during childhood.

Many have accepted limitations they were never meant to carry.

But God's purpose for humanity has never changed.

From the beginning, He intended for men and women to walk with Him, know Him, and reflect His glory in the earth.

Throughout Scripture, we find individuals who discovered this truth.

They were not necessarily the strongest, wealthiest, or most educated people of their generation. What made them different was their understanding of God and their understanding of who they were in relationship with Him.

Consider David.

A shepherd boy overlooked by his own family.

To others, he appeared insignificant.

Yet David understood something his brothers did not.

He knew God.

When he faced Goliath, he was not impressed by the giant's size because he was more aware of God's greatness than he was of the giant's strength.

The God Factor transformed an ordinary shepherd into a king.

Consider Daniel.

A young man carried into captivity in Babylon.

Everything around him suggested defeat.

His homeland had been conquered.

His future appeared uncertain.

Yet Daniel refused to allow circumstances to determine his identity. He knew God, and because he knew God, he stood firm when others compromised.

Centuries later, the angelic message recorded in Daniel 11:32 would capture the secret of his life:

"The people who know their God shall be strong, and carry out great exploits."

Notice that strength comes after knowing God.

Exploits come after strength.

The foundation of extraordinary living is a genuine knowledge of God.

Then there is Jesus Christ.

No one demonstrated the God Factor more perfectly than Him.

Jesus did not merely come to save humanity from sin; He came to reveal the life God intended mankind to live.

Where others saw impossibilities, Jesus saw opportunities.

Where others saw lack, He saw provision.

Where others saw death, He spoke life.

He lived with an awareness of the Father's presence that enabled Him to rise above the limitations of the natural world.

Again and again, Jesus declared that His works flowed from His relationship with the Father.

He lived from divine connection.

He demonstrated what becomes possible when a human life is fully surrendered to God.

The same principle remains true today.

The world often teaches us to depend solely on our own abilities.

Society encourages self-reliance while neglecting dependence upon God.

People are told to trust their feelings, follow popular opinions, and pursue personal ambition at all costs.

Yet history repeatedly proves that human strength alone is insufficient.

Education is valuable, but it cannot answer every challenge.

Money is useful, but it cannot buy peace.

Influence may open doors, but it cannot guarantee fulfilment.

True significance is found only when people discover God's purpose for their lives.

This discovery is what I call **The God Factor**.

The God Factor is the awareness that you were created by God, sustained by God, called by God, and empowered by God.

It is the understanding that your life is not merely the product of human effort but the result of divine intention.

It is recognizing that God's presence changes everything.

The God Factor does not mean life will be free from challenges.

David still faced giants.

Joseph still experienced betrayal.

Daniel still entered the lions' den.

Paul still endured persecution.

Even Jesus faced the cross.

The difference was not the absence of difficulties.

The difference was the presence of God.

The God Factor enables ordinary people to accomplish extraordinary things because they are no longer relying solely on themselves.

They become aware that God is working in and through them.

As you read this book, my prayer is that you will begin a journey of discovery.

A journey beyond religious tradition.

A journey beyond mere knowledge.

A journey beyond human limitations.

I pray that you will discover who God is and who He created you to be.

For the greatest discovery a person can ever make is not discovering a new continent, a new invention, or a new opportunity.

The greatest discovery is discovering your identity in God.

When that discovery takes place, fear loses its power.

Purpose becomes clear.

Faith comes alive.

And life is never the same again.

Welcome to the journey.

Welcome to **The God Factor**.

Chapter 1

The Breath That Changed Everything

"And the Lord God formed man of the dust of the ground, and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living being." — Genesis 2:7

Among all the miracles recorded in Scripture, the creation of man stands as one of the most remarkable.

When God created the heavens and the earth, He simply spoke. His word carried power. His voice brought worlds into existence. Light appeared. Oceans formed. Mountains rose. Trees sprang from the ground. Birds filled the skies, and fish filled the seas.

Everything came into existence through the command of God.

But when God created man, the process was different.

The Bible tells us that God formed man from the dust of the ground. Then He did something He did not do with any other part of creation.

He breathed into him.

The breath of God entered the lifeless body, and man became a living soul.

This was more than the beginning of human life.

It was the beginning of a unique relationship between God and man.

Man was not designed merely to exist.

He was created to carry something of God's nature, God's purpose, and God's presence.

This divine breath is what separates humanity from every other living creature.

More Than a Body

Many people spend their lives focusing only on the physical side of existence.

They work to feed the body.

They exercise to strengthen the body.

They dress to improve the appearance of the body.

While these things are important, they do not address the deepest part of who we are.

Man is more than flesh and bones.

He is more than a collection of organs and muscles.

There is a spiritual dimension within every human being.

Ecclesiastes 3:11 tells us that God has placed eternity in the human heart.

Deep within every person is a longing that nothing in this world can fully satisfy.

People search for fulfilment through success.

Others seek it through wealth.

Some pursue pleasure.

Others chase recognition and influence.

Yet after obtaining these things, many discover that the emptiness remains.

Why?

Because the human spirit was created for God.

Just as the body needs food, the spirit needs fellowship with its Creator.

Without that connection, a person may be alive physically while remaining empty spiritually.

The Lamp That Was Never Plugged In

A businessman once purchased an expensive lamp for his office.

It was beautifully designed and imported from another country.

Every visitor admired it.

The businessman proudly displayed it on his desk.

Yet for years, the lamp never produced light.

One day a friend visited and asked,

"Why don't you turn it on?"

The businessman replied,

"It has never worked since I bought it."

His friend walked over, picked up the cord, and plugged it into a nearby outlet.

Instantly the lamp illuminated the entire room.

The problem was not with the lamp.

The problem was with the connection.

Many lives are exactly like that lamp.

People possess incredible potential.

They have talents, gifts, intelligence, and opportunities.

Yet something is missing.

The missing element is connection with God.

Without that connection, people struggle to fulfil their true purpose.

When the connection is restored, life begins to function as it was originally designed.

The Enemy's Greatest Strategy

If there is one thing the enemy desires, it is to keep people ignorant of who they really are.

He understands that a person who knows God and understands their identity becomes difficult to defeat.

That is why from the beginning, Satan attacked man's understanding of himself.

In the Garden of Eden, he convinced Adam and Eve to doubt God's word.

He introduced confusion where there had once been clarity.

He caused them to question what God had already said.

The same strategy continues today.

Many people know their weaknesses better than they know God's promises.

They know every reason they might fail but very few reasons they might succeed.

They focus on what they lack instead of what God has provided.

As a result, they live beneath their calling.

The enemy cannot stop God's purpose for your life unless he first convinces you that you are incapable of fulfilling it.

This is why understanding your identity is so important.

The Story of the Young Lion

A young lion became separated from its pride shortly after birth.

A shepherd found the cub and raised it among sheep.

As the years passed, the lion behaved exactly like the sheep.

It ate grass.

It followed the flock.

It ran whenever danger appeared.

One day a mature lion from the wild saw the strange sight.

A lion behaving like a sheep.

The older lion chased the flock and cornered the young lion.

Terrified, the young lion trembled.

The older lion dragged him to a river.

"Look into the water," he commanded.

The young lion looked.

For the first time, he saw his reflection beside that of the older lion.

The two faces were nearly identical.

The sheep he had lived among did not resemble him at all.

The older lion let out a mighty roar.

Then he told the younger lion to do the same.

At first, only a weak sound emerged.

But after several attempts, a powerful roar burst forth.

At that moment, the young lion discovered who he truly was.

His behaviour changed because his identity changed.

Many believers are living like that young lion.

They possess the life of God within them but think like victims.

They have authority yet live in fear.

They have purpose yet live aimlessly.

The moment they discover who they are in God, everything begins to change.

David's Secret

When David arrived at the battlefield where Goliath was mocking Israel, he immediately noticed something different from everyone else.

The soldiers saw a giant.

David saw a giant opposing God.

That distinction changed everything.

David's confidence did not come from his size.

It did not come from military training.

It did not come from superior weapons.

His confidence came from knowing God.

He remembered the lion and the bear.

He remembered God's faithfulness in private.

He remembered the victories that no one else had witnessed.

While others focused on Goliath's strength, David focused on God's power.

This is the effect of understanding the God Factor.

It shifts your attention from your limitations to God's ability.

The Breath Still Matters

The breath that God placed in man at creation still matters today.

Every achievement of mankind has been made possible because God created humanity with creativity, intelligence, imagination, and purpose.

Scientists discover because God gave them minds.

Artists create because God gave them imagination.

Leaders influence because God gave them abilities.

Inventors innovate because God gave them creativity.

Every good gift ultimately traces back to the Creator.

Yet many people enjoy God's gifts while forgetting the Giver.

The greatest use of life is not merely achieving success.

The greatest use of life is knowing the One who gave life in the first place.

Discovering Your True Identity

One of the most important moments in life occurs
when a person stops asking,

"What do others think about me?"

and begins asking,

"What does God say about me?"

The world may define you by your failures.

God defines you by His purpose.

The world may see your limitations.

God sees your potential.

The world may focus on your past.

God focuses on your future.

Your identity is not found in your circumstances.

It is not found in your family background.

It is not found in your income, education, or social
status.

Your true identity is found in your relationship with
God.

Until that discovery is made, life will always feel
incomplete.

But when it is made, everything changes.

Reflection

The breath of God transformed dust into a living being.

That same God still desires to transform ordinary lives into extraordinary testimonies.

The God Factor begins with understanding a simple but life-changing truth:

You are more than what you see in the mirror.

You were created by God.

You were designed for purpose.

You were made for relationship with Him.

And until you discover that reality, you will never fully understand who you are.

The journey of discovering the God Factor starts here—with the realization that you are not merely dust.

You are dust touched by the breath of God.

Chapter 2

Created for More Than Survival

“Then God said, ‘Let Us make man in Our image, according to Our likeness; let them have dominion...’” — Genesis 1:26

Many people spend their entire lives surviving.

They wake up in the morning, go to work, pay bills, solve problems, and prepare for another day of doing the same thing all over again.

Life becomes a cycle.

A routine.

A struggle to make it through another week.

For some, survival becomes the goal.

They are not pursuing purpose.

They are simply trying to endure.

They are not living; they are existing.

But God did not create man merely to survive.

He created man to live with purpose, vision, authority, and impact.

The lion was created to rule the wilderness.

The eagle was created to soar above the storms.

The fish was created to swim through the depths of the sea.

Likewise, man was created for something greater than survival.

He was created to reflect the image of God in the earth.

The Difference Between Existing and Living

There is a difference between existing and living.

A tree exists.

An animal exists.

But man was designed to live with awareness, purpose, and relationship with God.

Many people are alive physically but dead to their purpose.

They have never asked why they were born.

They have never discovered their assignment.

They have never understood the reason God placed them on earth.

As a result, they move through life without direction.

Imagine boarding a ship that has no destination.

No matter how beautiful the vessel may be, eventually the passengers will become frustrated.

Movement without purpose leads nowhere.

Many lives are like that ship.

People are busy but not effective.

Active but not productive.

Moving but not progressing.

God's intention was never for life to be a meaningless journey.

Every person was born with a divine purpose.

The King Who Forgot His Crown

There is an old story about a king's son who was kidnapped as a child.

The kidnappers abandoned him in a distant village where he grew up among poor labourers.

The boy knew nothing about his royal heritage.

He worked long hours.

He wore worn-out clothes.

He struggled to survive.

He believed poverty was his destiny because it was all he had ever known.

Years later, an elderly servant from the palace found him.

The servant recognized the royal birthmark on his arm.

"You are not a labourer," the servant said.

"You are the son of the king."

The young man laughed.

"Look at me," he replied.

"I have nothing. I own nothing. I am nobody."

The servant smiled.

"You believe that because of where you have lived. But your identity was determined long before your circumstances."

The servant took him to the palace.

There he discovered who he truly was.

The moment he understood his identity, his entire outlook changed.

His surroundings had shaped his thinking, but they had never changed who he really was.

Many believers live exactly like that forgotten prince.

They have accepted limitations that God never intended.

They have allowed circumstances to define them.

They have forgotten whose image they carry.

Created in the Image of God

The first chapter of Genesis reveals a powerful truth.

God said,

"Let Us make man in Our image, according to Our likeness."

This statement separates humanity from every other created thing.

Man was created to reflect God's character, creativity, wisdom, and authority.

This does not mean man is God.

Rather, it means humanity was designed to reveal God's nature in the earth.

When people discover this truth, they stop seeing themselves as accidents.

They stop believing their lives are meaningless.

They begin to understand that they were created intentionally.

You are not here by chance.

You are not a mistake.

You are not the result of random events.

God knew you before you were born.

He saw your future before you entered the world.

He designed you with purpose.

The God Factor begins with recognizing that your existence is intentional.

The Tragedy of Small Thinking

One of the greatest enemies of purpose is small thinking.

Many people spend their lives trapped within invisible walls.

These walls are not made of stone.

They are made of beliefs.

"I could never do that."

"I am not educated enough."

"I am too old."

"I am too young."

"I come from the wrong family."

"I do not have enough resources."

Such thoughts have imprisoned more people than iron bars ever could.

Consider Moses.

When God called him to deliver Israel, Moses immediately focused on his weaknesses.

He questioned his ability.

He doubted his qualifications.

He emphasized his limitations.

God's response was simple:

"Certainly I will be with you." (Exodus 3:12)

God was teaching Moses an important lesson.

Success would not depend on Moses alone.

It would depend on God's presence.

The God Factor is not about confidence in yourself.

It is confidence in God working through you.

The Seed That Refused to Grow

A farmer planted two seeds in fertile soil.

The first seed pushed through the ground and began to grow.

It stretched toward the sunlight and developed into a strong tree.

The second seed remained buried.

It was afraid.

Afraid of storms.

Afraid of insects.

Afraid of failure.

Days became weeks.

Weeks became months.

The second seed never grew.

One day a bird found it and ate it.

Its potential died beneath the soil.

The tragedy was not that the seed lacked potential.

The tragedy was that it never embraced its purpose.

Many people spend their lives like that second seed.

Fear prevents them from becoming what God intended.

Fear of rejection.

Fear of criticism.

Fear of failure.

Fear of change.

Yet purpose is discovered only when we step beyond fear.

Jesus and the Purpose-Driven Life

No one lived with greater purpose than Jesus.

From an early age, He understood why He had come.

Every decision He made was connected to His mission.

When others sought comfort, He pursued purpose.

When others sought popularity, He pursued obedience.

When others focused on earthly gain, He focused on eternal impact.

Even at twelve years old, Jesus said,

"Did you not know that I must be about My Father's business?" (Luke 2:49)

His life reminds us that fulfilment is not found in self-centred living.

True fulfilment comes from discovering and fulfilling God's purpose.

Purpose gives meaning to sacrifice.

Purpose gives strength during difficulty.

Purpose provides direction in uncertain times.

A person who knows their purpose can endure challenges that would cause others to quit.

More Than a Pay check

Work is important.

Providing for family is important.

Meeting responsibilities is important.

But life was never meant to revolve solely around earning a living.

A person can make money and still miss purpose.

A person can become successful and still feel empty.

Why?

Because purpose is greater than occupation.

Your job is what you do.

Your purpose is why you exist.

Some people's purpose may be fulfilled through business.

Others through ministry.

Others through teaching, leadership, medicine, farming, parenting, writing, or countless other callings.

The specific assignment may differ, but the principle remains the same.

God created every individual for a reason.

Discovering that reason changes everything.

Living With Dominion

When God created man, He gave him dominion.

Dominion does not mean oppression.

It means stewardship.

Responsibility.

Influence.

Authority under God's leadership.

Man was never intended to be controlled by fear, sin, or circumstances.

He was created to walk in partnership with God.

This is why the enemy continually attacks identity.

He knows that a person who understands their God-given purpose becomes a force for good in the world.

History is filled with men and women who changed their generation because they discovered God's purpose for their lives.

They were not always the strongest.

They were not always the most talented.

But they understood why they were here.

And that understanding gave them courage to act.

Reflection

Life is more than survival.

You were not created merely to eat, sleep, work, and repeat the same cycle until the end of your days.

You were created in the image of God.

You were designed with purpose.

You were born with an assignment.

The world may try to reduce your life to survival.

But God calls you to significance.

The God Factor reminds us that we are not accidents wandering through history.

We are people created by divine design, carrying divine purpose.

And when a person discovers that purpose, survival gives way to significance, and existence becomes a life of impact.

You were created for more than survival.

You were created for purpose.

Chapter 3

The Tragedy of Forgotten Identity

“My people are destroyed for lack of knowledge.” —
Hosea 4:6

There are few tragedies greater than a person living their entire life without discovering who they truly are.

Imagine possessing great wealth but never knowing it.

Imagine inheriting a vast estate but living as a beggar because no one informed you of your inheritance.

Imagine carrying the key to a prison cell while believing you are trapped forever.

Such situations would seem unthinkable.

Yet this is exactly how many people live every day.

They possess gifts they have never discovered.

They carry potential they have never explored.

They have access to God's promises but live as though they have none.

The greatest prison in the world is not made of concrete and steel.

It is a prison of mistaken identity.

When people forget who they are, they begin living beneath their purpose.

They accept limitations they were never meant to carry.

They settle for less than God's intention for their lives.

And often, they do so without realizing it.

A Prince Living as a Beggar

Many years ago, a kingdom was shaken by tragedy when the young prince disappeared during a time of unrest.

Search parties were sent across the land.

Rewards were offered.

But the child was never found.

Years passed.

The kingdom mourned and eventually accepted the loss.

Unknown to everyone, the prince had survived.

A traveling merchant had found him and raised him as his own son.

The boy grew into a man without any knowledge of his royal heritage.

He worked in the markets.

He carried heavy loads.

He struggled to earn enough money for food.

Though he was legally heir to a kingdom, he lived as a poor labourer.

One day an elderly advisor from the palace recognized a unique birthmark on the young man's shoulder.

After careful investigation, the truth emerged.

The labourer was the lost prince.

At first, he could hardly believe it.

Everything he had known told him he was poor.

Everything around him confirmed the life of a servant.

Yet the evidence was undeniable.

His identity had never changed.

Only his understanding of it had.

The day he discovered the truth, his future changed forever.

Not because he became someone new.

But because he finally discovered who he had always been.

Many believers are living like that prince.

They have forgotten their identity.

They have forgotten whose image they bear.

They have forgotten the authority, purpose, and inheritance available through their relationship with God.

The First Identity Crisis

The first identity crisis in human history occurred in the Garden of Eden.

Before sin entered the world, Adam and Eve enjoyed perfect fellowship with God.

They knew who they were.

They understood their purpose.

They walked in confidence and authority.

There was no shame.

No fear.

No confusion.

But when sin entered the picture, everything changed.

Suddenly, Adam and Eve hid from God.

The very people who once walked openly with their Creator now lived in fear.

For the first time, insecurity entered the human experience.

When God called out, "Where are you?" it was not because God had lost track of Adam.

It was because Adam had lost sight of himself.

Since that day, humanity has wrestled with questions of identity.

People have searched for meaning in success, possessions, relationships, achievements, and recognition.

Yet none of these things can permanently answer the question of who we are.

Only God can do that.

The Labels People Carry

One of the enemy's favourite strategies is attaching false labels to people.

A child struggles in school and is labelled "slow."

A young person makes mistakes and is labelled "failure."

Someone experiences rejection and begins believing they are "unwanted."

A business collapses, and the owner starts seeing himself as a "loser."

Over time, these labels become part of a person's self-image.

People begin living according to what they believe about themselves.

The danger is that many of these labels are not true.

They are conclusions based on temporary experiences.

God never intended your identity to be determined by your worst moment.

David failed, yet he was still called a man after God's own heart.

Peter denied Jesus, yet he became a pillar of the early church.

Moses made mistakes, yet he became a deliverer.

Your failures may describe events in your life, but they do not define who you are.

Gideon and the Hidden Hero

The story of Gideon provides one of the clearest examples of forgotten identity.

When we first meet Gideon, he is hiding.

The Midianites had oppressed Israel for years.

Fear had become normal.

Defeat had become expected.

Gideon was threshing wheat in a winepress, trying to avoid being noticed by the enemy.

Then an angel appeared with a surprising message:

"The Lord is with you, you mighty man of valour!"
(Judges 6:12)

Imagine how strange those words must have sounded.

Gideon did not feel mighty.

He did not see himself as courageous.

He certainly did not feel like a hero.

In fact, he immediately began listing reasons why the angel must be mistaken.

He pointed to his family background.

He pointed to his weaknesses.

He pointed to his limitations.

But God saw something Gideon could not see.

God saw the man Gideon was created to become.

The rest of the story reveals a remarkable transformation.

The fearful man became a courageous leader.

The doubter became a deliverer.

The hidden man became a hero.

What changed?

His identity.

Once Gideon began seeing himself through God's eyes, his actions changed.

The Mirror Problem

There is an interesting truth about mirrors.

They only reflect what stands before them.

If the mirror is damaged, distorted, or dirty, the reflection may not accurately represent reality.

Many people are looking into the wrong mirrors.

They look into the mirror of public opinion.

They look into the mirror of past failures.

They look into the mirror of social comparison.

They look into the mirror of personal insecurity.

As a result, they develop a distorted view of themselves.

God's Word functions as a different kind of mirror.

It reveals who God says we are.

It reminds us that we are created in His image.

It reminds us that we are loved, valued, and called for a purpose.

The more we see ourselves through God's truth, the more our lives begin to align with that truth.

The Elephant and the Rope

A traveller once noticed a group of elephants standing quietly beside a road.

Surprisingly, each elephant was secured by nothing more than a small rope tied around one leg.

The traveller asked the trainer why the elephants did not simply break free.

The trainer explained.

"When they are young, we tie them with the same rope. At that age, they are not strong enough to break it. Over time, they become conditioned to believe they cannot escape. Even when they grow strong enough to break the rope easily, they never try because they still believe they are bound."

The traveller was astonished.

The elephants remained captive not because of the rope but because of what they believed.

Many people are held back by invisible ropes.

The rope of fear.

The rope of doubt.

The rope of insecurity.

The rope of past experiences.

The rope is often weaker than they think.

Yet they remain bound because they have accepted a false identity.

Jesus and Identity

One of the reasons Jesus lived with such confidence was because He knew who He was.

Throughout His ministry, people questioned Him.

Religious leaders opposed Him.

Crowds misunderstood Him.

Yet Jesus remained secure in His identity.

His confidence did not come from public approval.

It came from His relationship with the Father.

At His baptism, before performing miracles or preaching sermons, God declared:

"This is My beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased."
(Matthew 3:17)

Notice the timing.

God affirmed Jesus before His public ministry began.

His identity came before His achievements.

The same principle applies to us.

We do not earn our value through performance.

Our value begins with God's love and purpose.

Recovering What Was Lost

The journey of transformation begins when people recover their true identity.

The prodigal son experienced this realization.

While feeding pigs in a distant land, he remembered who he was.

He remembered his father's house.

He remembered his inheritance.

He remembered his identity.

That realization changed everything.

Before his circumstances changed, his thinking changed.

Before he reached home, he had already begun the journey back.

Many breakthroughs begin the same way.

They begin when a person remembers who they are.

Not who others say they are.

Not who fear says they are.

Not who failure says they are.

But who God says they are.

Reflection

The greatest loss in life is not losing money, possessions, or opportunities.

The greatest loss is losing sight of who you are.

When identity is forgotten, purpose becomes blurred.

When identity is forgotten, fear gains influence.

When identity is forgotten, people settle for less than God's best.

But the moment identity is restored, everything begins to change.

Like the lost prince, you discover an inheritance you never knew existed.

Like Gideon, you begin seeing possibilities where you once saw limitations.

Like the prodigal son, you find your way home.

The God Factor begins with knowing God.

But it also involves knowing who you are because of Him.

For when you discover your true identity, you no longer live according to your fears.

You begin living according to your purpose.

And that changes everything.

Chapter 4

The Eagle Among Chickens

“Those who wait on the Lord shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings like eagles...” — Isaiah 40:31

There is a story that has been told in many forms over the years. Though simple, it carries a profound lesson

about identity, potential, and the danger of accepting limitations that were never meant to define us.

It is the story of an eagle that forgot it was an eagle.

One day, a farmer found an eagle's egg lying near the edge of a mountain path. Concerned that it would not survive, he took it home and placed it among the eggs in his chicken coop.

Days later, the egg hatched.

The young eagle emerged alongside a group of chicks.

It grew up among them.

It learned what they learned.

It did what they did.

It scratched the ground looking for food.

It flapped its wings only enough to hop a short distance.

It spent its days pecking at the dirt and wandering around the farmyard.

As far as the young eagle knew, it was a chicken.

After all, that was the environment in which it had been raised.

That was all it had ever seen.

That was all it had ever known.

The Power of Environment

Environment has tremendous influence over our lives.

The people around us shape our thinking.

The voices we listen to influence our beliefs.

The experiences we encounter affect our expectations.

A child repeatedly told that they are incapable may eventually believe it.

A person surrounded by negativity may begin expecting failure.

Someone raised in an atmosphere of fear may struggle to embrace opportunities.

Environment is powerful.

But there is something even more powerful.

Identity.

Environment may influence who you think you are, but it cannot change who God created you to be.

An eagle raised among chickens remains an eagle.

A prince raised among servants remains a prince.

A child of God living among unbelief remains a child of God.

Your surroundings may affect your perspective, but they cannot alter your God-given identity.

Living Below Your Design

Years passed, and the eagle continued living like the chickens.

One afternoon, while searching for food, it noticed a magnificent bird soaring high above the mountains.

The bird glided effortlessly through the sky.

It appeared strong, fearless, and free.

The young eagle watched in amazement.

"What is that?" it asked one of the chickens.

The chicken looked up and replied,

"That is an eagle."

"An eagle?" the young bird asked.

"Yes," said the chicken. "The eagle is the king of the skies. It flies where we cannot go. It sees what we cannot see. But don't waste your time thinking about it. We are chickens."

The young eagle accepted the explanation.

It lowered its head and continued scratching in the dirt.

It never attempted to fly.

It never discovered its true nature.

It died believing it was something it had never been.

That story is tragic because it reflects the lives of many people.

They live far below their design.

Not because they lack potential.

Not because God failed to equip them.

But because they have accepted a false identity.

What God Sees Versus What You See

One of the most important lessons in Scripture is that God often sees something different from what people see.

When Samuel went to anoint Israel's next king, he assumed the choice would be one of Jesse's older sons.

They looked impressive.

They appeared qualified.

They seemed like natural leaders.

Yet God rejected them all.

Then David was brought in.

A shepherd boy.

The youngest son.

Overlooked by his own family.

No one expected him to become king.

But God saw what others could not see.

The Lord told Samuel:

"For the Lord does not see as man sees; for man looks at the outward appearance, but the Lord looks at the heart." (1 Samuel 16:7)

People often judge according to appearances.

God sees purpose.

People see limitations.

God sees possibilities.

People focus on the present.

God sees the future.

The God Factor enables us to see ourselves through God's perspective rather than human opinion.

The Danger of Comparison

One reason many people never discover their potential is because they spend their lives comparing themselves to others.

Comparison is one of the greatest enemies of purpose.

The eagle could never become a great chicken.

Its destiny was not found in mastering the life of a chicken.

Its destiny was found in becoming what it was created to be.

Likewise, your purpose is not found in becoming someone else.

God did not create you to be a copy.

He created you to be uniquely you.

Comparison leads to frustration because it causes people to pursue identities that do not belong to them.

Some compare their gifts.

Others compare their appearance.

Others compare their success.

Yet God never called us to comparison.

He called us to faithfulness.

The goal is not to become another person.

The goal is to become the person God designed you to be.

The Awakening

Let us imagine that the story of the eagle ended differently.

Suppose one day a mature eagle descended from the mountains and landed in the farmyard.

The chickens scattered in fear.

The young eagle stared in amazement.

The visitor approached and asked,

"What are you doing here?"

"I am a chicken," the young bird replied.

The older eagle laughed.

"No, you are not."

"Yes, I am," the young eagle insisted.

"I eat with chickens. I live with chickens. I walk with chickens."

The older eagle shook his head.

"You may live among chickens, but you are an eagle."

The young bird resisted.

It argued.

It doubted.

It questioned.

Finally, the older eagle led it to a nearby lake.

"Look into the water."

The young bird looked.

For the first time, it noticed that its reflection resembled the eagle standing beside it far more than the chickens around it.

Something began to change.

A realization dawned.

It had been living beneath its nature.

The older eagle spread his wings.

"Now do what you were created to do."

The young eagle hesitated.

Then it stretched its wings.

At first, it struggled.

It stumbled.

It nearly fell.

But eventually, it caught the wind.

Slowly, it rose above the farmyard.

For the first time in its life, it experienced the freedom for which it had been created.

That moment changed everything.

The Voices That Shape Us

Every person must decide which voices they will believe.

The chickens told the eagle it could never fly.

The older eagle told it the truth.

Likewise, there are many voices competing for our attention.

The voice of fear says:

"You are not capable."

The voice of failure says:

"You have already missed your opportunity."

The voice of the past says:

"You will never change."

The voice of society says:

"Stay where you are."

But God's voice says:

"I created you for more."

"I have plans for your life."

"You are stronger than you think."

"My grace is sufficient for you."

The future of the eagle depended upon which voice it believed.

The same is true for us.

Jesus and Human Potential

Jesus constantly challenged people to see beyond their limitations.

When others saw fishermen, Jesus saw apostles.

When others saw a tax collector, Jesus saw a disciple.

When others saw a persecutor named Saul, God saw the Apostle Paul.

Jesus specialized in revealing what people could become through God's power.

He never defined people by their past.

He saw their potential.

He saw their destiny.

He saw what God's grace could accomplish in their lives.

The God Factor allows us to see ourselves the same way.

Not through the lens of failure.

Not through the lens of fear.

But through the lens of God's purpose.

The Choice to Soar

The eagle's greatest challenge was not physical.

It was mental.

Its wings were capable of flight long before it believed they were.

Many people are waiting for circumstances to change before they move forward.

Yet often the first thing God changes is not the circumstance.

It is the mind-set.

Before Gideon could deliver Israel, he had to see himself differently.

Before Moses could lead a nation, he had to believe God could use him.

Before Peter could preach to thousands, he had to move beyond fear.

Transformation begins with a renewed understanding of who we are in God.

When identity changes, actions follow.

When actions change, lives change.

When lives change, destinies unfold.

Reflection

The tragedy of the eagle was not that it lacked wings.

The tragedy was that it never used them.

Many people possess gifts they never develop.

Dreams they never pursue.

Callings they never embrace.

Not because God withheld ability, but because they accepted a false picture of themselves.

The God Factor calls us higher.

It reminds us that we were not created to spend our lives scratching in the dirt when God designed us to soar.

You may have been raised among limitations.

You may have been surrounded by doubt.

You may have been told what you cannot do.

But none of those things determine your destiny.

What determines your destiny is discovering who God says you are.

For the day an eagle discovers it is an eagle is the day it begins to fly.

And the day a believer discovers their identity in God is the day they begin to rise above the limitations that once held them captive.

Chapter 5

The Discovery That Changes Everything

“That I may know Him and the power of His resurrection...” — Philippians 3:10

There are discoveries that change the course of history.

The discovery of fire transformed civilization.

The discovery of electricity changed the modern world.

The discovery of new lands reshaped nations.

Yet there is a discovery greater than all of these.

It is the discovery of God.

And closely connected to it is another life-changing discovery—the discovery of who you are because of Him.

Many people know about God.

They know religious facts.

They can quote scriptures.

They attend church services.

They understand theological concepts.

Yet knowing about God and knowing God are not the same thing.

A person may know many things about a king without ever meeting him.

A person may read books about a great leader without having a relationship with that leader.

In the same way, many people possess information about God but have never developed a genuine relationship with Him.

The greatest transformation begins when knowledge becomes relationship.

The Difference Between Information and Revelation

There is a difference between information and revelation.

Information fills the mind.

Revelation transforms the life.

Information tells you God is powerful.

Revelation causes you to trust His power.

Information tells you God is faithful.

Revelation gives you confidence during difficult times.

Information says God is your Father.

Revelation enables you to live as His child.

Many people have information.

Few pursue revelation.

That is why two people can read the same scripture and experience completely different results.

One sees words on a page.

The other encounters a living truth.

The difference is not in the scripture.

The difference is in the understanding.

The Young Man Searching for Success

A young man once approached a respected mentor.

"Tell me the secret of success," he said.

The mentor smiled.

"Meet me by the river tomorrow morning."

The next day, the young man arrived.

The mentor led him into the water.

They walked deeper and deeper until the water reached the young man's chest.

Suddenly, the mentor grabbed him and pushed his head beneath the surface.

The young man struggled.

Seconds passed.

Then more seconds.

Finally, just before he could no longer endure it, the mentor released him.

The young man burst from the water, gasping for air.

"What was that for?" he demanded.

The mentor calmly asked,

"When your head was underwater, what did you desire most?"

"Air!" the young man replied.

"Nothing else mattered. I wanted air."

The mentor nodded.

"When you desire purpose, truth, and the knowledge of God with that same intensity, you will discover them."

The young man never forgot the lesson.

The greatest discoveries are not made by casual seekers.

They are made by those who hunger for truth.

Moses and the Burning Bush

Moses had spent forty years in the wilderness.

Once a prince of Egypt, he had become a shepherd.

His dreams seemed buried.

His future appeared ordinary.

Then one day he encountered a burning bush.

What made the bush remarkable was not merely that it burned.

It was that it burned without being consumed.

As Moses approached, God spoke.

That encounter changed everything.

Moses entered the wilderness as a shepherd.

He left with a calling.

He approached the bush as a fugitive.

He departed as a deliverer.

What changed?

He encountered God.

One genuine encounter with God can accomplish what years of human effort cannot.

The God Factor becomes real when God is no longer a distant concept but a living reality.

Job's Greatest Discovery

Few people suffered as much as Job.

He lost wealth.

He lost servants.

He lost children.

He lost health.

He endured pain that most people cannot imagine.

Throughout his trials, Job wrestled with difficult questions.

He sought understanding.

He sought answers.

But when God finally revealed Himself, something extraordinary happened.

Job declared:

"I have heard of You by the hearing of the ear, but now my eye sees You." (Job 42:5)

Notice the difference.

Before, Job had heard about God.

Now, he knew Him.

Before, his understanding was second-hand.

Now, it was personal.

That revelation changed everything.

True faith is not built upon what others know about God.

It is built upon what you personally discover about Him.

Peter's Great Revelation

One day Jesus asked His disciples a question.

"Who do men say that I, the Son of Man, am?"

The disciples responded with various opinions.

Some believed Jesus was John the Baptist.

Others thought He was Elijah.

Still others believed He was one of the prophets.

Then Jesus asked a more important question:

"But who do you say that I am?"

Peter answered:

"You are the Christ, the Son of the living God."

Jesus responded:

"Blessed are you, Simon Bar-Jonah, for flesh and blood has not revealed this to you, but My Father who is in heaven." (Matthew 16:17)

Peter's answer did not come from human reasoning.

It came through revelation.

The same principle applies today.

Your life changes when God's truth moves from your head to your heart.

Discovering Who You Are

The moment you discover who God is, another question naturally follows.

Who am I because of Him?

This question is crucial.

Many believers understand God's greatness but struggle to understand their identity.

They know God is powerful.

But they feel weak.

They know God is loving.

But they feel rejected.

They know God forgives.

But they continue living under condemnation.

The problem is not God's willingness.

The problem is their understanding.

Throughout Scripture, God continually reminded His people of who they were.

Israel was called God's chosen people.

David was called a man after God's own heart.

The disciples were called friends.

Believers are called children of God.

These identities are not earned through perfection.

They are received through relationship.

The Story of the Mirror Room

There was once a large room lined entirely with mirrors.

One day a frightened dog accidentally wandered inside.

Seeing thousands of dogs staring back at him, he became terrified.

He growled.

Immediately, thousands of dogs appeared to growl back.

He barked aggressively.

Thousands of dogs barked in return.

The frightened animal spent the night attacking reflections until he collapsed from exhaustion.

The next day, a cheerful dog entered the same room.

He wagged his tail.

Thousands of tails wagged back.

He barked joyfully.

Thousands of dogs appeared happy to see him.

He left delighted.

The room had not changed.

Only the perspective had changed.

Many people see life through the mirror of fear, failure, and insecurity.

As a result, everything appears threatening.

But when people begin seeing themselves through God's truth, their perspective changes.

And when perspective changes, life changes.

Paul's Greatest Pursuit

The Apostle Paul accomplished extraordinary things.

He planted churches.

He wrote much of the New Testament.

He influenced generations.

Yet despite all his accomplishments, his greatest desire was simple.

"That I may know Him..."

Not merely know about Him.

Know Him.

Paul understood something many people miss.

Success without intimacy with God is incomplete.

Achievements without relationship leave the soul unsatisfied.

The greatest treasure in life is not what you accomplish.

It is whom you know.

And there is no greater relationship than knowing God.

The Discovery That Unlocks Destiny

Every person reaches a crossroads.

One path leads to a life defined by circumstances.

The other leads to a life defined by relationship with God.

The first path produces fear.

The second produces faith.

The first focuses on limitations.

The second focuses on possibilities.

The first relies solely on human ability.

The second embraces the God Factor.

History is filled with ordinary people who became extraordinary because they discovered God.

Abraham became the father of nations.

Moses became a deliverer.

David became a king.

Daniel influenced empires.

Peter became a bold preacher.

None of them began as extraordinary individuals.

What set them apart was their relationship with God.

The discovery of God transformed their lives.

And that same discovery still changes lives today.

Reflection

The greatest discovery a person can make is not discovering a new opportunity, a new career, or a new destination.

It is discovering God.

And from that discovery comes another equally important revelation:

Who am I because of Him?

When that truth takes root in the heart, fear begins to lose its grip.

Purpose becomes clearer.

Faith grows stronger.

Life gains new meaning.

The God Factor is not merely about believing that God exists.

It is about knowing Him personally and allowing that relationship to shape every part of your life.

For when you truly know God, you begin to discover who you were created to be.

And that discovery changes everything.

Chapter 6

David and the Secret of Fearless Living

“The Lord who delivered me from the paw of the lion and from the paw of the bear, He will deliver me from the hand of this Philistine.” — 1 Samuel 17:37

Fear is one of the greatest forces that shapes human behaviour.

It has stopped people from pursuing dreams.

It has prevented leaders from taking action.

It has silenced voices that were meant to influence nations.

Fear has caused countless individuals to settle for less than what God intended for their lives.

Yet throughout history, there have been men and women who seemed to rise above fear.

They faced impossible situations with confidence.

They confronted challenges that caused others to retreat.

They stood firm when everyone else ran.

One of those people was David.

His story is not merely the story of a shepherd defeating a giant.

It is the story of a young man who discovered the God Factor.

It is the story of someone who learned that when God is greater in your heart than the problem before your eyes, fear loses its power.

The Valley of Fear

The Valley of Elah was filled with tension.

On one side stood the army of Israel.

On the other side stood the Philistines.

Between them was a giant named Goliath.

For forty days he came forward and challenged Israel.

Morning after morning.

Evening after evening.

The same challenge echoed across the valley.

"Choose a man to fight me."

Yet no one moved.

The soldiers were trained warriors.

King Saul himself was known for his size and military experience.

But fear had captured them.

The giant's voice became stronger than their faith.

His presence became larger than their confidence in God.

The entire nation was being controlled by one man's intimidation.

This is how fear operates.

It magnifies obstacles until they appear larger than God.

A Different Perspective

One day David arrived at the battlefield carrying food for his brothers.

He was not a soldier.

He had no military rank.

He possessed no armour.

He had no reputation as a warrior.

Yet when he heard Goliath's challenge, he reacted differently from everyone else.

The soldiers saw an unbeatable giant.

David saw an uncircumcised Philistine defying the armies of the living God.

The giant had not changed.

The battlefield had not changed.

The circumstances had not changed.

The difference was perspective.

David's view of God was greater than his view of the giant.

Many people spend their lives studying their problems.

David spent his life studying God.

And because of that, he saw challenges differently.

The Secret Place of Preparation

Most people remember David's victory over Goliath.

Few remember the preparation that came before it.

Long before David stood before a giant, he stood before lions.

Long before he faced a Philistine warrior, he faced bears.

Long before he became known publicly, he developed character privately.

The wilderness became David's classroom.

The lonely hills became his training ground.

While watching sheep, he learned to trust God.

While protecting the flock, he learned courage.

While playing his harp, he learned worship.

While spending time in God's presence, he learned faith.

The victories no one saw prepared him for the victory everyone would celebrate.

This principle remains true today.

Many people want public success without private preparation.

They desire visible victories without hidden growth.

Yet God often develops greatness in secret before revealing it in public.

The Testimony of Yesterday

When Saul questioned David's ability to fight Goliath,
David shared an important testimony.

He spoke about the lion.

He spoke about the bear.

He remembered what God had already done.

Faith grows when we remember God's faithfulness.

Fear says:

"What if God does not help you?"

Faith replies:

"He helped me before."

Fear says:

"This challenge is too great."

Faith responds:

"God has already brought me through other
challenges."

David's confidence was not based on wishful thinking.

It was based on experience.

He knew God's faithfulness from personal encounters.

The God Factor becomes stronger every time we remember what God has done.

The Voice of Discouragement

Before David faced Goliath, he had to overcome other battles.

One of those battles came through discouragement.

His oldest brother criticized him.

Saul doubted him.

Others questioned him.

No one seemed to believe he could succeed.

This reveals an important truth.

Not everyone will understand what God is doing in your life.

Some people see only your age.

Others see only your background.

Others focus on your limitations.

They judge you according to what they know.

God judges according to what He has planned.

Had David listened to every negative voice, he would never have stepped onto the battlefield.

Sometimes faith requires ignoring voices that contradict God's purpose.

Rejecting Another Man's Armour

Saul eventually agreed to let David fight.

But first, he gave David his armour.

The king's armour was impressive.

It looked appropriate for battle.

Yet when David tried it on, he could barely move.

The armour belonged to Saul, not David.

David understood something important.

He could not win someone else's way.

He had to fight with what God had given him.

So he removed the armour.

He picked up his shepherd's staff.

He selected five smooth stones.

And he carried the sling he had used throughout his years as a shepherd.

The lesson is powerful.

Many people fail because they spend their lives trying to become someone else.

God did not create you to wear another person's armour.

He created you to fulfil your unique assignment.

Your strength is found in becoming who God called you to be.

Running Toward the Giant

One of the most remarkable moments in the story occurs just before the battle.

The Bible says David ran toward Goliath.

Most people run away from giants.

David ran toward one.

Why?

Because he understood something the others did not.

The battle was not ultimately about David and Goliath.

It was about God.

David knew that if God was with him, the giant's size did not matter.

Fear causes people to retreat.

Faith causes people to advance.

Fear focuses on the obstacle.

Faith focuses on God.

The God Factor does not eliminate challenges.

It changes how we respond to them.

The Stone and the Giant

The battle itself was surprisingly brief.

Goliath mocked David.

He laughed at the sight of a shepherd boy standing before him.

To the giant, victory seemed certain.

But David's confidence was not in the stone.

It was not in the sling.

It was not in his own skill.

His confidence was in God.

With one well-placed stone, the giant fell.

The Philistine champion collapsed to the ground.

The battle that had terrified an entire nation ended in a matter of moments.

The giant fell because David understood a truth that others had forgotten:

No challenge is greater than God.

Giants Still Exist

Most people will never face a giant named Goliath.

But everyone faces giants.

Some face financial giants.

Others face health challenges.

Some battle fear, anxiety, or discouragement.

Others face rejection, disappointment, or uncertainty.

The names of the giants may change.

The principle remains the same.

The God who gave David victory is still the same today.

The God Factor enables believers to face modern giants with ancient faith.

It reminds us that God has not changed.

His power has not diminished.

His promises have not expired.

His faithfulness remains.

Fearless Does Not Mean Fear-Free

Many people misunderstand courage.

They assume courage means never feeling afraid.

But courage is not the absence of fear.

Courage is moving forward despite fear.

David was human.

He understood the danger before him.

He knew the giant could kill him.

Yet he refused to let fear determine his actions.

His faith became stronger than his fear.

Every great act of faith requires this decision.

The choice to trust God even when circumstances seem overwhelming.

The choice to move forward when retreat appears easier.

The choice to believe God's promise despite what the eyes can see.

The God Factor in Every Battle

David's greatest weapon was not his sling.

It was his relationship with God.

His confidence came from knowing that he was not alone.

The same principle applies to us.

The God Factor is not confidence in our strength.

It is confidence in God's presence.

It is knowing that God is greater than the challenge.

It is believing that God can accomplish what human ability cannot.

It is understanding that no giant can stand forever against the purposes of God.

When people discover this truth, they stop living as victims.

They begin living as overcomers.

Reflection

The story of David and Goliath is not ultimately about a giant.

It is about God.

It is about what happens when an ordinary person develops extraordinary confidence in God.

David was not fearless because he was stronger than Goliath.

He was fearless because he knew God.

The soldiers looked at the giant and concluded victory was impossible.

David looked at God and concluded defeat was impossible.

That is the difference the God Factor makes.

It changes perspective.

It transforms fear into faith.

It turns obstacles into opportunities.

And it reminds us that no matter how large the giant appears, God is always greater.

For those who know their God do not live controlled by fear.

They live empowered by faith.

And through that faith, they accomplish what others believe cannot be done.

Chapter 7

Joseph: Dreams Cannot Be Imprisoned

“But the Lord was with Joseph...” — Genesis 39:2

There are moments in life when circumstances seem to contradict God's promises.

You pray, yet the answer appears delayed.

You believe, yet challenges increase.

You obey God, yet doors seem to close instead of open.

In such moments, many people begin to question God's plan.

They wonder if they misunderstood His voice.

They wonder if their dreams were merely imagination.

They wonder if their destiny has somehow been lost.

Joseph understood these feelings.

If anyone had reason to give up on God's promises, it was Joseph.

Yet his story reveals one of the greatest truths about the God Factor:

God-given dreams cannot be imprisoned by human circumstances.

Men may oppose them.

Situations may delay them.

Challenges may test them.

But if God has spoken, His purpose will prevail.

A Dream from God

Joseph was only a young man when God began revealing His future.

Through dreams, God showed him that one day he would occupy a position of influence and leadership.

His future appeared bright.

His destiny seemed glorious.

But destiny often begins with a promise before it reaches fulfilment.

Many people celebrate the dream but fail to understand the process.

The dream is exciting.

The process is challenging.

Joseph would soon discover that God's promises often travel through unexpected paths.

The Pit

Joseph's brothers became jealous.

Instead of celebrating God's favour upon his life, they resented it.

Jealousy turned into hatred.

Hatred turned into conspiracy.

One day they seized Joseph and threw him into a pit.

Imagine the confusion.

The young man who had received divine dreams now sat alone in a dark hole.

Nothing about the pit resembled God's promise.

Nothing about the situation made sense.

Yet the pit was not the end of Joseph's story.

Sometimes life places us in pits.

The pit of disappointment.

The pit of rejection.

The pit of betrayal.

The pit of unanswered questions.

In those moments, it is easy to assume that God has forgotten us.

But often the pit is merely a chapter, not the conclusion.

The God Factor teaches us that God's purpose is greater than temporary setbacks.

Sold but Not Abandoned

Joseph's brothers eventually sold him into slavery.

The dreamer became a servant.

The favoured son became property.

Everything seemed to move in the wrong direction.

Many people assume that God's favour guarantees an easy journey.

Joseph's life proves otherwise.

God's favour does not always remove difficulties.

Sometimes it sustains us through them.

The remarkable truth about Joseph's story is found in a phrase repeated throughout Scripture:

"The Lord was with Joseph."

Notice what the Bible does not say.

It does not say Joseph was free from trouble.

It does not say Joseph avoided hardship.

It says God was with him.

That made all the difference.

The God Factor is not the absence of problems.

It is the presence of God in the middle of them.

Excellence in Unfavourable Conditions

As a slave in Potiphar's house, Joseph faced a choice.

He could become bitter.

He could complain.

He could surrender to despair.

Instead, he chose excellence.

Though treated unfairly, he worked faithfully.

Though his circumstances were difficult, he maintained integrity.

Though he had every reason to lose hope, he remained committed.

Soon Potiphar noticed something unusual.

Everything Joseph touched prospered.

Why?

Because Joseph carried the God Factor.

His circumstances did not determine his attitude.

His relationship with God did.

One of the greatest signs of spiritual maturity is the ability to remain faithful even when life seems unfair.

Anyone can serve God when things are going well.

The true test comes when circumstances become difficult.

The Test of Integrity

Success brought another challenge.

Potiphar's wife attempted to seduce Joseph.

No one would have known.

No one would have seen.

No one appeared capable of stopping him.

Yet Joseph refused.

His response revealed his heart.

"How then can I do this great wickedness, and sin against God?" (Genesis 39:9)

Notice that Joseph's primary concern was not his reputation.

It was his relationship with God.

Character is revealed when no one is watching.

Integrity is proven in private.

The God Factor is not merely about power.

It is also about character.

God often tests character before releasing greater responsibility.

The Prison

Because Joseph refused temptation, he was falsely accused and thrown into prison.

Once again, circumstances seemed to move further away from God's promise.

First the pit.

Then slavery.

Now prison.

From a human perspective, Joseph's life appeared to be moving backward.

Yet heaven saw something different.

The prison was not punishment.

It was preparation.

God was positioning Joseph for something greater.

Many people become discouraged because they judge their lives only by present circumstances.

God sees the bigger picture.

He sees what we cannot see.

He knows what we do not know.

The God Factor enables us to trust God's process even when we do not understand it.

Faithfulness in the Dark

Prison could have destroyed Joseph's spirit.

Instead, it revealed his character.

Even there, he remained faithful.

Even there, he served others.

Even there, he continued trusting God.

Before long, the prison keeper entrusted responsibilities to him.

Once again, favour followed faithfulness.

This reveals an important principle.

Your location does not determine your potential.

A prison could not stop Joseph.

A wilderness could not stop Moses.

A lion's den could not stop Daniel.

A giant could not stop David.

Circumstances are powerful, but they are not more powerful than God's purpose.

Forgotten but Not Forsaken

While in prison, Joseph interpreted dreams for two fellow prisoners.

One of them was restored to Pharaoh's service.

Before leaving, Joseph asked him to remember him.

The man promised he would.

But he forgot.

Days passed.

Weeks passed.

Months passed.

Years passed.

Joseph remained in prison.

Forgotten by man.

But not forgotten by God.

One of the most difficult tests in life is the test of waiting.

Waiting challenges faith.

Waiting tests patience.

Waiting exposes whether our trust is truly in God.

Joseph discovered that delays are not denials.

God's timing is often different from ours.

Yet His timing is always perfect.

The Suddenly of God

After years of waiting, everything changed in a single day.

Pharaoh had troubling dreams that no one could interpret.

Suddenly, the former prisoner remembered Joseph.

Suddenly, Joseph was summoned.

Suddenly, the forgotten man stood before the king.

Years of preparation led to one moment of opportunity.

Joseph interpreted Pharaoh's dreams.

His wisdom astonished the king.

Then something remarkable happened.

The prisoner became a governor.

The slave became a leader.

The dreamer became a ruler.

In a single day, God accomplished what years of human effort could not.

This is one of the great lessons of the God Factor.

When God's appointed time arrives, no obstacle can prevent His purpose.

Looking Back with Understanding

Years later, Joseph stood before the brothers who had betrayed him.

Now he possessed power.

He could have taken revenge.

He could have punished them.

Instead, he revealed a heart shaped by God.

He said:

"You meant evil against me; but God meant it for good..." (Genesis 50:20)

Joseph had learned to see his life from God's perspective.

He understood that God had been working even when circumstances seemed painful.

The pit had a purpose.

The slavery had a purpose.

The prison had a purpose.

Every chapter contributed to God's larger plan.

This is one of the deepest expressions of faith.

The ability to trust that God is working even when we cannot see it.

Dreams Beyond Circumstances

Many people allow circumstances to bury their dreams.

Joseph refused.

The pit could not destroy his dream.

Slavery could not destroy his dream.

Prison could not destroy his dream.

Because the dream did not originate with Joseph.

It originated with God.

When God plants a dream in the heart of a person, opposition may come.

Challenges may arise.

Delays may occur.

But God's purpose remains.

The God Factor reminds us that our future is not ultimately determined by circumstances.

It is determined by God's faithfulness.

Reflection

Joseph's life teaches us that destiny is stronger than adversity.

The God Factor does not promise a trouble-free journey.

Joseph's path included betrayal, injustice, loneliness, and waiting.

Yet through it all, one truth remained constant:

The Lord was with Joseph.

That truth made the difference.

When God is with you, the pit is not the end.

The prison is not the end.

The disappointment is not the end.

The delay is not the end.

God's purpose is greater than any obstacle.

Dreams born from God cannot be imprisoned forever.

For in God's perfect time, what He has promised will come to pass.

And when it does, you will discover that every challenge along the way was preparing you for the fulfilment of His purpose.

Chapter 8

Moses: From Insecurity to Authority

“Certainly I will be with you.” — Exodus 3:12

One of the greatest lies ever whispered into the human heart is this:

"You are not enough."

Not smart enough.

Not talented enough.

Not educated enough.

Not experienced enough.

Not strong enough.

Not qualified enough.

Countless dreams have died because people believed those words.

Many have walked away from opportunities because they felt inadequate.

Others have spent years hiding from their purpose because they were convinced that God could never use someone like them.

If anyone understood these feelings, it was Moses.

When we think of Moses today, we think of a mighty leader.

We think of the man who confronted Pharaoh.

The man who parted the Red Sea.

The man through whom God gave the Law.

The man who led a nation.

But Moses did not begin that way.

Before he became a deliverer, he was an insecure man running from his past.

His story reminds us that God's calling is always greater than human weakness.

A Child Preserved by God

Moses entered the world during a dangerous time.

The king of Egypt had ordered the death of Hebrew baby boys.

Fear spread throughout the land.

Families hid their children.

Mothers wept.

Hope seemed distant.

Yet God had a plan.

Moses' mother placed him in a basket and set him among the reeds of the Nile River.

To human eyes, it appeared risky.

To God, it was part of His purpose.

The basket drifted until it was discovered by Pharaoh's daughter.

The child who should have died was adopted into the palace.

The one marked for destruction was being prepared for destiny.

This is often how God works.

While people see danger, God sees opportunity.

While people see impossibility, God sees purpose.

The God Factor reminds us that God can preserve a life even in hostile circumstances.

The Prince Who Lost His Way

Moses grew up in Egypt's royal courts.

He received the finest education.

He learned leadership.

He understood government.

He enjoyed privilege and influence.

Yet despite living in the palace, Moses never forgot that he was Hebrew.

One day, while observing the suffering of his people, he witnessed an Egyptian beating a Hebrew slave.

Anger filled his heart.

In a moment of impulsive action, Moses killed the Egyptian.

The next day, his secret was discovered.

Fear overtook him.

The prince became a fugitive.

He fled into the wilderness.

The man who once lived in a palace now found himself tending sheep in the desert.

Years passed.

Dreams faded.

Opportunities disappeared.

The future looked ordinary.

What Moses did not realize was that God was not finished with him.

The Wilderness School

The wilderness became Moses' classroom.

For forty years he cared for sheep.

Day after day.

Month after month.

Year after year.

The pace was slow.

The lessons were quiet.

The environment seemed insignificant.

Yet God was preparing him.

Leadership requires patience.

Character requires development.

Faith requires testing.

The wilderness teaches lessons that palaces cannot.

Many people despise their wilderness seasons.

They see them as wasted years.

Yet some of God's greatest work happens in hidden places.

David learned faith while watching sheep.

Joseph learned endurance in prison.

Paul learned dependence on God in Arabia.

Moses learned humility in the wilderness.

The God Factor often develops people in private before using them publicly.

The Burning Bush

One ordinary day, everything changed.

Moses noticed a bush that burned without being consumed.

Curious, he moved closer.

Then he heard a voice.

"Moses, Moses."

The voice came from God.

In that moment, Moses encountered the living God.

The shepherd became aware that heaven had stepped into his ordinary day.

God revealed His plan.

He intended to deliver Israel from slavery.

And Moses was chosen to lead the mission.

What happened next surprises many readers.

Moses began arguing.

The Language of Insecurity

God called.

Moses resisted.

God spoke purpose.

Moses pointed out problems.

Again and again, Moses presented reasons why he was the wrong choice.

"Who am I that I should go?"

"What if they don't believe me?"

"I am not eloquent."

"Please send someone else."

His words reveal the voice of insecurity.

Moses focused on his limitations.

God focused on His purpose.

Moses looked at himself.

God looked at what He could accomplish through him.

This is one of the most important lessons in Scripture.

God rarely calls people because they are sufficient in themselves.

He calls them because He is sufficient.

God's Answer to Human Weakness

Notice that God did not respond by praising Moses' abilities.

He did not say:

"Moses, you are smarter than you think."

"You are stronger than you think."

"You are more talented than you think."

Instead, God gave a different answer.

"Certainly I will be with you."

The solution to Moses' weakness was God's presence.

The answer to insecurity was not self-confidence.

It was God-confidence.

Many people spend years trying to overcome fear by focusing on themselves.

God points them in a different direction.

He points them toward Himself.

The God Factor begins when people stop asking, "Am I enough?" and start believing, "God is enough."

The Staff in His Hand

At one point, God asked Moses a simple question.

"What is that in your hand?"

Moses answered,

"A staff."

To Moses, it was an ordinary shepherd's tool.

To God, it was an instrument for miracles.

God instructed Moses to throw it on the ground.

The staff became a serpent.

Then God told him to pick it up again.

It returned to being a staff.

This moment carried a deeper lesson.

God often uses ordinary things to accomplish extraordinary purposes.

Many people overlook what God has already placed in their hands.

They focus on what they lack.

They focus on what others possess.

Meanwhile, God is waiting for them to recognize what He has already provided.

The God Factor transforms ordinary resources into instruments of divine purpose.

Standing Before Pharaoh

Eventually Moses obeyed.

The fearful shepherd walked into Pharaoh's palace.

Years earlier he had fled in fear.

Now he returned with authority.

The difference was not Moses' natural ability.

The difference was God's presence.

Again and again Moses stood before the most powerful ruler of his day.

Again and again he delivered God's message.

Again and again God demonstrated His power.

The man who once questioned his calling became the voice of deliverance for an entire nation.

This transformation did not happen because Moses became perfect.

It happened because he trusted God.

The Red Sea Moment

One of the greatest tests came after Israel left Egypt.

The people found themselves trapped.

Mountains surrounded them.

The sea stood before them.

Pharaoh's army approached from behind.

Panic spread throughout the camp.

The people cried out in fear.

Everything appeared hopeless.

Yet Moses responded differently.

The insecure shepherd had become a leader of faith.

He declared:

"Stand still, and see the salvation of the Lord."
(Exodus 14:13)

Then God parted the Red Sea.

What seemed impossible became possible.

A pathway appeared where none existed before.

The people crossed safely.

The pursuing army was defeated.

The God Factor turned an impossible situation into a testimony.

Authority Through Relationship

One of the remarkable aspects of Moses' life was his relationship with God.

The Bible says God spoke with Moses "face to face, as a man speaks to his friend."

His authority flowed from intimacy.

His influence flowed from relationship.

His leadership flowed from God's presence.

This is an important principle.

True spiritual authority does not come from titles.

It does not come from position.

It comes from walking with God.

The more Moses knew God, the more confidently he fulfilled his calling.

The same principle remains true today.

Strength grows through relationship.

Confidence grows through intimacy with God.

Purpose becomes clearer through fellowship with Him.

The Journey from Fear to Faith

Moses began his journey full of excuses.

He ended it leading a nation.

He began questioning God's choice.

He ended speaking God's words with authority.

He began focused on weakness.

He ended focused on God's power.

The transformation was not instantaneous.

It happened step by step.

Decision by decision.

Act of obedience by act of obedience.

This encourages every believer.

You do not have to become fearless overnight.

You do not have to understand everything immediately.

You simply need to take the next step of obedience.

As you do, God develops your faith.

And faith grows stronger than fear.

Reflection

Moses' story is the story of countless people.

People who feel unqualified.

People who struggle with insecurity.

People who wonder whether God can truly use them.

The answer is yes.

God specializes in using ordinary people for extraordinary purposes.

He used a shepherd to confront Pharaoh.

He used a stutterer to speak to nations.

He used a fugitive to become a deliverer.

Not because of their strength.

But because of His presence.

The God Factor reminds us that God's calling is always greater than human weakness.

When God says, "I will be with you," everything changes.

Insecurity gives way to confidence.

Fear gives way to faith.

Weakness becomes a platform for God's power.

For the greatest qualification for fulfilling God's purpose is not human ability.

It is God's presence.

And wherever His presence is found, extraordinary things become possible.

Chapter 9

Gideon: Seeing Yourself Through God's Eyes

“The Lord is with you, you mighty man of valour!”
— Judges 6:12

One of the greatest battles a person will ever fight is not a battle against an enemy on the outside.

It is a battle against wrong perceptions on the inside.

Many people are defeated long before they ever face a challenge because they have already accepted defeat in their minds.

They see themselves as weak.

They see themselves as incapable.

They see themselves as ordinary.

As a result, they live according to what they believe rather than according to what God says.

Yet throughout Scripture, God repeatedly demonstrates a remarkable truth:

God sees people differently than they see themselves.

Where people see weakness, God sees potential.

Where people see failure, God sees possibility.

Where people see insignificance, God sees destiny.

The story of Gideon is one of the clearest examples of this truth.

It is the story of a man who discovered the God Factor and learned to see himself through God's eyes.

Living Under Oppression

Israel was going through a dark season.

Because of their disobedience, they had fallen under the oppression of the Midianites.

Year after year, the enemy invaded their land.

Whenever the Israelites planted crops, the Midianites would come and destroy them.

Whenever they prepared for harvest, the enemy would steal the fruit of their labour.

Fear spread throughout the nation.

People hid in caves.

They lived in constant anxiety.

They survived rather than thrived.

Hope seemed distant.

Freedom seemed impossible.

Among the people suffering under this oppression was a young man named Gideon.

At first glance, there was nothing remarkable about him.

He was not a famous leader.

He was not a celebrated warrior.

He was simply trying to survive.

Hiding in the Winepress

When we first meet Gideon, he is threshing wheat in a winepress.

Normally wheat was threshed in an open area where the wind could separate the grain from the chaff.

But Gideon was hiding.

He was afraid the Midianites would steal his harvest.

His actions reflected the condition of the entire nation.

Fear had become normal.

Hiding had become a way of life.

Many people today live in similar ways.

Not necessarily hiding physically.

But hiding emotionally.

Hiding spiritually.

Hiding from opportunities.

Hiding from challenges.

Hiding from their calling.

Fear convinces them that staying small is safer than stepping forward.

Yet God never created His people to live controlled by fear.

Heaven's Introduction

As Gideon worked in the winepress, an angel of the Lord appeared.

The first words spoken to Gideon were surprising:

"The Lord is with you, you mighty man of valour!"

Imagine hearing those words while hiding from your enemies.

To Gideon, they probably sounded absurd.

Mighty?

He did not feel mighty.

Valorous?

He certainly did not feel courageous.

The angel's statement seemed completely disconnected from reality.

Yet heaven was not describing Gideon's present condition.

Heaven was declaring his true identity.

God was speaking to who Gideon was meant to become.

This is often how God works.

He speaks to potential before it becomes visible.

He calls people according to purpose before they see the evidence.

He sees the finished picture while we only see the unfinished sketch.

Gideon's Objections

Like many people, Gideon immediately began listing reasons why God must be mistaken.

He questioned God's presence.

He pointed to Israel's suffering.

He focused on his family's weakness.

He emphasized his own insignificance.

"My clan is the weakest in Manasseh, and I am the least in my father's house." (Judges 6:15)

In essence, Gideon was saying:

"You have the wrong person."

How many times have people responded the same way when God placed a dream in their hearts?

"I don't have enough education."

"I don't have enough money."

"I don't have enough experience."

"I come from the wrong background."

"I am not the right person."

Gideon's objections are still alive today.

The details may change, but the mind-set remains the same.

People focus on their limitations while God focuses on His power.

God's Perspective

Notice God's response.

He did not argue with every excuse.

He did not spend time debating Gideon's weaknesses.

Instead, God pointed Gideon toward the most important truth:

"Surely I will be with you." (Judges 6:16)

The answer was not found in Gideon's ability.

The answer was found in God's presence.

This is the heart of the God Factor.

God never asks people to fulfil His purpose alone.

He calls them into partnership with Him.

When God is involved, weakness is no longer the determining factor.

His strength becomes the difference.

The Battle Within

Before Gideon could defeat Midian, he had to overcome another enemy.

The enemy within.

His fear.

His insecurity.

His wrong self-image.

This is true for many people.

They spend years praying for external breakthroughs while ignoring internal struggles.

Yet the greatest victories often begin in the mind.

The battlefield of life is frequently won or lost before the first action is taken.

The enemy knows this.

That is why he attacks identity.

If he can convince people they are incapable, many will never attempt what God has called them to do.

If he can keep them focused on weakness, they will overlook God's strength.

The first miracle Gideon needed was not military victory.

It was a renewed understanding of who he was.

Tearing Down the Altars

God's first assignment for Gideon was unexpected.

Before confronting Midian, he had to tear down the altar of Baal in his own community.

The problem was not only external oppression.

There was also internal compromise.

The people had allowed false worship to occupy a place that belonged to God.

Gideon obeyed.

Though afraid, he acted.

Though uncertain, he moved forward.

This reveals an important principle.

Faith does not require the absence of fear.

Faith requires obedience despite fear.

Every act of obedience strengthens faith.

Every step forward builds confidence.

Every victory prepares us for greater victories.

The Army Reduction

Eventually Gideon gathered an army.

Thousands of men responded.

From a human perspective, this was encouraging.

The larger the army, the greater the chance of victory.

Yet God saw things differently.

He began reducing the numbers.

First thousands were sent home.

Then more were dismissed.

Eventually only three hundred remained.

Three hundred men against a vast enemy force.

The situation seemed impossible.

But God was teaching a lesson.

The victory would not come through human strength.

It would come through divine power.

The God Factor often removes reasons for self-reliance so that people learn dependence on God.

The Night of Victory

Armed with trumpets, jars, and torches, Gideon's small army approached the enemy camp.

The strategy made little sense from a military standpoint.

No swords.

No impressive weapons.

No overwhelming force.

Yet the battle belonged to God.

At Gideon's signal, the men broke their jars, revealed their torches, and sounded their trumpets.

Confusion spread throughout the enemy camp.

The Midianites turned against one another.

Panic erupted.

The enemy fled.

A victory that seemed impossible became reality.

Not because Gideon's army was stronger.

But because God was greater.

Seeing Yourself Through God's Eyes

The most remarkable part of Gideon's story is not the battle.

It is the transformation.

The fearful man hiding in a winepress became the courageous leader of a nation.

The doubter became a deliverer.

The insecure man became a mighty warrior.

What changed?

His identity.

Gideon eventually began seeing himself the way God saw him.

Once that happened, everything else followed.

His actions changed because his beliefs changed.

His courage grew because his understanding grew.

His future changed because his perspective changed.

The Mirror of God's Word

Many people look into mirrors that distort reality.

Some look into the mirror of past mistakes.

Others look into the mirror of rejection.

Others look into the mirror of criticism.

These mirrors produce a false image.

God's Word functions differently.

It reveals what God says about us.

It reminds us that we are created in His image.

It reminds us that we are loved.

It reminds us that we are called.

It reminds us that we are empowered by His Spirit.

The more we look into that mirror, the more accurately we understand who we truly are.

The God Factor and Identity

The God Factor is closely connected to identity.

As long as Gideon saw himself as weak, he remained hidden.

As long as he focused on his limitations, he remained afraid.

But when he embraced God's perspective, he stepped into his calling.

The same principle applies today.

God's view of you is greater than your view of yourself.

He sees possibilities where you see obstacles.

He sees strength where you see weakness.

He sees purpose where you see confusion.

The journey of faith involves learning to trust God's perspective above your own.

Reflection

Gideon's story reminds us that our greatest limitations are often not external.

They are internal.

The enemy wants people to focus on weakness.

God wants people to focus on His presence.

The enemy magnifies fear.

God magnifies purpose.

The enemy reminds us of what we lack.

God reminds us of who He is.

The God Factor begins transforming lives when people stop defining themselves by their limitations and start defining themselves by God's truth.

Like Gideon, you may feel unqualified.

You may feel ordinary.

You may feel incapable.

But God's call is not based on your limitations.

It is based on His purpose.

And when God says, "The Lord is with you," everything changes.

For when you begin seeing yourself through God's eyes, you discover that you are capable of far more than you ever imagined.

And what once seemed impossible becomes possible through the power and presence of God.

Chapter 10

Daniel: The Power of Knowing God

“The people who know their God shall be strong, and carry out great exploits.” — Daniel 11:32

Among all the powerful statements found in Scripture, few are as inspiring as these words from the Book of Daniel:

“The people who know their God shall be strong, and carry out great exploits.”

Notice what the verse does not say.

It does not say those who know about God.

It does not say those who attend religious gatherings.

It does not say those who possess great education, wealth, or influence.

It says those who **know their God**.

There is a difference.

Knowledge about God can be learned from books.

Knowledge of God is developed through relationship.

Knowledge about God informs the mind.

Knowledge of God transforms the life.

Daniel's story is one of the clearest demonstrations of this truth.

He lived in difficult circumstances.

He faced enormous pressure.

He endured threats, opposition, and persecution.

Yet throughout his life, he displayed remarkable courage, wisdom, and faith.

His secret was simple.

Daniel knew God.

Captured but Not Conquered

Daniel's journey began with tragedy.

The nation of Judah had fallen to Babylon.

Jerusalem had been conquered.

The temple had been plundered.

Many of the people were taken into captivity.

Among those captives was a young man named Daniel.

From a natural perspective, everything seemed lost.

His homeland was gone.

His culture was under attack.

His future appeared uncertain.

Many people would have allowed such circumstances to define them.

But Daniel refused.

Though Babylon captured his body, it never captured his heart.

Though he lived in a foreign land, he remained loyal to God.

The God Factor teaches us that circumstances may affect our environment, but they do not have to determine our identity.

The Test of Conviction

Soon after arriving in Babylon, Daniel faced his first major test.

The king ordered that selected young men receive food and wine from the royal table.

For many, this was a privilege.

For Daniel, it presented a spiritual challenge.

The food violated convictions rooted in God's law.

No one would have blamed Daniel for compromising.

After all, he was far from home.

He was a captive.

He was under pressure.

Yet Daniel made a decision.

"Daniel purposed in his heart that he would not defile himself..." (Daniel 1:8)

Everything begins in the heart.

Long before courage is displayed publicly, it is developed privately.

Long before people stand for God in difficult situations, they make internal decisions about what they believe.

Daniel's strength did not begin in the lion's den.

It began with a decision to honour God in everyday circumstances.

Excellence That Could Not Be Ignored

As time passed, Daniel distinguished himself.

He excelled in wisdom.

He excelled in understanding.

He excelled in character.

Even unbelieving rulers recognized something unusual about him.

The Bible repeatedly highlights God's favour upon Daniel's life.

This favour did not make him lazy.

It motivated excellence.

One misconception held by some believers is that faith eliminates the need for diligence.

Daniel's life proves otherwise.

He trusted God deeply, yet he worked faithfully.

He prayed consistently, yet he developed his skills.

The God Factor does not encourage mediocrity.

It inspires excellence.

People who know God should strive to reflect His character in everything they do.

The Dream Nobody Could Explain

One night King Nebuchadnezzar had a troubling dream.

The dream disturbed him so deeply that he demanded an interpretation.

The problem was that he refused to tell anyone what the dream was.

He expected his wise men to reveal both the dream and its meaning.

The request was impossible.

The wise men admitted it.

The king became furious.

A death sentence was issued against all the wise men of Babylon.

Daniel's life suddenly hung in the balance.

Yet instead of panicking, Daniel turned to God.

He gathered his friends and prayed.

That night God revealed both the dream and its interpretation.

The next day Daniel stood before the king.

The impossible became possible.

Not because Daniel was extraordinary.

But because he knew the God who reveals mysteries.

This is one of the great advantages of the God Factor.

When human wisdom reaches its limits, God's wisdom remains limitless.

The Courage to Stand Alone

One of the greatest tests of faith is standing alone.

It is easy to follow God when everyone agrees.

It is more difficult when obedience creates opposition.

Throughout his life Daniel repeatedly found himself in this position.

He lived in a culture that did not share his beliefs.

He served under rulers who did not worship his God.

Yet he remained faithful.

Many people adjust their convictions according to public opinion.

Daniel adjusted his life according to God's truth.

His commitment was not based on convenience.

It was based on relationship.

People who truly know God develop convictions that cannot easily be shaken.

The Lion's Den

Daniel's most famous test came later in life.

By this time he had risen to a position of influence within the kingdom.

His success created jealousy.

Enemies searched for ways to destroy him.

Unable to find fault in his character, they targeted his faith.

A decree was issued forbidding prayer to anyone except the king.

The punishment for disobedience was death in a lion's den.

Daniel knew the decree had been signed.

He understood the consequences.

Yet his response was remarkable.

He went home.

Opened his windows toward Jerusalem.

And prayed as he always had.

He did not become rebellious.

He did not become dramatic.

He simply remained faithful.

This is the strength that comes from knowing God.

Daniel's relationship with God was not dependent upon favourable circumstances.

It remained constant.

Peace in the Den

Daniel was arrested and thrown into the lion's den.

The king spent a sleepless night.

Daniel apparently did not.

The next morning the king rushed to the den and called out:

"Daniel, servant of the living God, has your God, whom you serve continually, been able to deliver you?"

A voice answered from within.

"My God sent His angel and shut the lions' mouths."
(Daniel 6:22)

The lions were real.

The danger was real.

Yet God's power was greater.

The God Factor does not deny reality.

It simply acknowledges a higher reality.

God remains sovereign over every circumstance.

Knowing God Produces Strength

Daniel's courage did not appear suddenly.

It was the result of years spent walking with God.

His strength came from relationship.

The same principle is found throughout Scripture.

David faced Goliath because he knew God.

Moses confronted Pharaoh because he knew God.

Joseph endured hardship because he knew God.

Paul persevered through suffering because he knew God.

Strength flows from relationship.

People become strong not merely by studying God's power but by experiencing His faithfulness.

Every answered prayer builds confidence.

Every victory strengthens faith.

Every encounter deepens trust.

The more we know God, the stronger we become.

Great Exploits

Daniel 11:32 contains two promises.

First, those who know their God shall be strong.

Second, they shall carry out great exploits.

Strength is not an end in itself.

It prepares us for purpose.

God strengthens people so they can influence others.

He empowers them so they can serve.

He develops faith so they can fulfil His assignments.

Daniel influenced kings.

Joseph saved nations from famine.

Esther preserved her people.

The apostles transformed the world.

None of them lived merely for themselves.

Their relationship with God produced impact.

The God Factor always leads beyond personal benefit.

It equips people to become instruments of God's purpose.

The Secret Place

If someone had asked Daniel for the secret of his life, the answer would likely have been simple.

Prayer.

Not public performance.

Not political influence.

Not personal ambition.

Prayer.

Daniel's public victories flowed from private devotion.

The lion's den revealed what years of prayer had produced.

The courage visible to everyone had been cultivated where no one was watching.

Many people admire spiritual strength but overlook spiritual disciplines.

Yet strength is developed through consistent fellowship with God.

Those who know God invest time in knowing Him.

The God Factor in a Modern World

The world today is different from ancient Babylon in many ways.

Yet the challenges remain similar.

People face pressure to compromise.

They encounter opposition to faith.

They are tempted to conform to cultural expectations.

Daniel's example remains relevant.

His life reminds us that believers can remain faithful regardless of their environment.

We do not need perfect circumstances to walk with God.

We need a genuine relationship with Him.

The same God who sustained Daniel still sustains His people today.

The same God who closed the mouths of lions still works in the lives of those who trust Him.

Reflection

Daniel's life proves that circumstances cannot limit a person who truly knows God.

Captivity could not stop him.

Pressure could not stop him.

Opposition could not stop him.

Lions could not stop him.

Why?

Because his strength came from God.

The God Factor is not about possessing extraordinary talent.

It is about possessing extraordinary trust in an extraordinary God.

When people know God, fear loses its power.

When people know God, faith grows stronger.

When people know God, obstacles become opportunities for God's glory.

Daniel's life stands as a timeless reminder that those who know their God shall indeed be strong.

And through that strength, they will accomplish exploits that reveal the greatness of the One they serve.

Chapter 11

Esther: Born for Such a Time as This

“Yet who knows whether you have come to the kingdom for such a time as this?” — Esther 4:14

One of the most important questions a person can ever ask is:

Why am I here?

Not merely, "Why am I alive?"

But, "Why was I born in this generation?"

"Why did God place me in this particular family, nation, community, and season of history?"

Many people move through life without ever considering these questions.

They see themselves as ordinary individuals living ordinary lives.

They assume their existence is accidental.

They fail to recognize that God works through ordinary people to accomplish extraordinary purposes.

The story of Esther reminds us that every life has significance.

No one is born by accident.

No one is placed in a generation without purpose.

God positions people strategically.

He places them where they are needed.

And often, they discover their purpose at the very moment it is needed most.

An Unlikely Beginning

Esther's story did not begin in a palace.

It began with loss.

She was an orphan.

Her parents had died, leaving her to be raised by her cousin Mordecai.

Life could have made Esther bitter.

She could have spent her years focusing on what she lacked.

Instead, she developed character, humility, and grace.

What she could not see was that God was quietly preparing her for an assignment far greater than she imagined.

Many people assume that destiny begins when opportunities appear.

Often destiny begins long before opportunities become visible.

God prepares people before He positions them.

The preparation is often hidden.

The purpose becomes visible later.

The Door Opens

A series of events led to Esther being brought before King Ahasuerus.

Among many young women presented to the king, Esther found favour.

Eventually she was chosen to become queen.

To human eyes, it may have appeared to be a fortunate coincidence.

But God's hand was at work.

The Bible never mentions coincidence when describing God's purposes.

He sees the beginning from the end.

He knows what is coming before it arrives.

While Esther was simply living her life, God was positioning her for a future assignment.

This is one of the truths revealed by the God Factor.

God is often arranging circumstances behind the scenes long before we understand what He is doing.

The Hidden Threat

Not long after Esther became queen, a dangerous man named Haman rose to power.

Consumed by pride and hatred, he developed a plan to destroy the Jewish people.

A decree was issued throughout the empire.

An entire nation faced extinction.

The situation seemed hopeless.

The enemy appeared powerful.

The people appeared vulnerable.

Yet unknown to Haman, God had already positioned someone inside the palace.

The queen was not there by accident.

She was there by divine design.

What appeared to be a political appointment was actually part of God's plan.

Mordecai's Challenge

When Mordecai learned of Haman's plot, he sent a message to Esther.

His words would become some of the most famous in Scripture.

"Do not think in your heart that you will escape in the king's palace any more than all the other Jews."

Then he added:

"Yet who knows whether you have come to the kingdom for such a time as this?"

Those words changed everything.

Suddenly Esther saw her position differently.

The palace was no longer merely a place of comfort.

It was a place of purpose.

Her crown was no longer simply an honour.

It was a responsibility.

Her influence was not for personal benefit alone.

It was meant to serve a greater purpose.

Many people see opportunities as blessings for themselves.

God often sees them as opportunities to bless others.

The Battle Between Comfort and Calling

Esther faced a difficult decision.

Approaching the king without invitation was dangerous.

The law was clear.

Anyone who entered the king's presence uninvited could be put to death.

The risk was real.

Fear was understandable.

She had two choices.

Remain silent and protect herself.

Or step forward and fulfil her purpose.

Every generation faces this same battle.

The battle between comfort and calling.

Comfort says:

"Stay where it is safe."

Calling says:

"Trust God and move forward."

Comfort seeks security.

Calling embraces purpose.

The God Factor empowers people to choose purpose over fear.

The Power of Preparation

Before approaching the king, Esther called for fasting.

For three days the people prayed and sought God.

This decision reveals an important principle.

Spiritual battles require spiritual preparation.

Esther understood that her challenge was greater than politics.

It required God's intervention.

Many people attempt to solve spiritual problems through human strength alone.

Esther sought God first.

The God Factor is not about self-confidence.

It is about dependence upon God.

Prayer aligns the heart with God's purpose.

Prayer invites God's wisdom into difficult situations.

Prayer prepares people for the assignments ahead.

Courage in Action

After the fast, Esther made her decision.

She declared:

"If I perish, I perish." (Esther 4:16)

These words reveal remarkable courage.

Esther was not acting recklessly.

She was acting faithfully.

There is a difference.

Faith is not ignoring danger.

Faith is obeying God despite danger.

Courage is not the absence of fear.

It is moving forward when fear would prefer retreat.

The God Factor transforms ordinary people into courageous people because they become more aware of God's presence than of their fears.

The Turning Point

Esther approached the king.

To her relief, he extended the golden sceptre.

Favour opened the door.

Wisdom guided her actions.

Instead of acting impulsively, she proceeded carefully.

Step by step, she revealed Haman's wicked plan.

Eventually the truth came to light.

The plot was exposed.

The enemy was defeated.

The people were preserved.

What seemed impossible became possible.

One woman's obedience changed the future of an entire nation.

More Than a Queen

Many people remember Esther as a queen.

But her greatest achievement was not wearing a crown.

It was fulfilling her purpose.

Titles come and go.

Positions change.

Influence rises and falls.

But purpose leaves a lasting impact.

Esther's significance did not come from her position.

It came from her willingness to obey God.

The same principle applies today.

God is not looking merely for talented people.

He is looking for willing people.

People who are willing to trust Him.

People who are willing to step forward when called.

People who are willing to place purpose above personal comfort.

Divine Timing

One of the remarkable themes throughout Esther's story is timing.

Had Esther become queen earlier, she may not have been in position to help.

Had she arrived later, the opportunity could have been lost.

God's timing was perfect.

This truth encourages believers today.

Many people become frustrated because they do not understand God's timing.

They compare their journey to others.

They wonder why certain opportunities have not yet appeared.

Yet God's timing is rarely accidental.

He positions people at the right place and the right moment for His purposes.

The God Factor teaches us to trust not only God's power but also His timing.

Discovering Your Assignment

Every person has an assignment.

It may not involve a palace.

It may not involve a kingdom.

But it matters.

Some are called to influence families.

Some are called to lead businesses.

Some are called to teach, mentor, serve, build, create, encourage, or minister.

The assignment differs.

The principle remains the same.

God places people where they can fulfil His purpose.

The challenge is recognizing that purpose and responding with faith.

Like Esther, many people do not initially understand why God has positioned them where they are.

Only later do they realize that God's hand was guiding them all along.

The God Factor and Purpose

The God Factor reminds us that life is not random.

God works through people, circumstances, opportunities, and challenges to accomplish His plans.

Esther discovered this truth.

What seemed like a series of unrelated events was actually divine orchestration.

The orphan became a queen.

The queen became a deliverer.

The deliverer became part of God's larger story.

Purpose transformed her ordinary life into an extraordinary testimony.

The same God who worked in Esther's life continues working today.

He still positions people.

He still opens doors.

He still calls individuals to rise for specific moments and assignments.

Reflection

Esther's story teaches us that every life has purpose.

You were not born accidentally.

You were not placed in this generation by chance.

You are here because God has a purpose for your life.

Like Esther, you may not fully understand that purpose today.

You may not recognize the significance of your current position.

You may not see how God is arranging events behind the scenes.

But He is.

The God Factor assures us that God is actively working through the details of our lives.

He prepares us before we understand why.

He positions us before we recognize the opportunity.

And when the right moment arrives, He calls us to step forward in faith.

The question is not whether God has a purpose for your life.

The question is whether you will embrace it.

For who knows?

Perhaps you, too, have been placed exactly where you are **for such a time as this.**

Chapter 12

Jesus: The Perfect Expression of the God Factor

“He who has seen Me has seen the Father.” — John 14:9

Throughout this book, we have explored the lives of remarkable men and women.

David faced giants.

Joseph overcame betrayal.

Moses confronted Pharaoh.

Gideon defeated fear.

Daniel stood firm in Babylon.

Esther fulfilled her divine assignment.

Each of these individuals revealed something important about the God Factor.

Yet all of them were imperfect.

They made mistakes.

They experienced weaknesses.

They occasionally failed.

There is only one person who perfectly demonstrated the God Factor.

His name is Jesus Christ.

When we look at Jesus, we see humanity as God intended it to be.

We see a life completely surrendered to the Father.

We see a person living above the limitations of the natural world while remaining fully dependent upon God.

Jesus did not merely teach about the God Factor.

He embodied it.

He lived it.

He revealed it.

God's Original Design Revealed

When God created Adam, His intention was that man would live in fellowship with Him.

Adam was designed to walk with God.

To know God.

To represent God in the earth.

Sin disrupted that relationship.

Fear entered.

Separation followed.

Humanity lost sight of its original purpose.

Then Jesus came.

He did not simply come to rescue humanity.

He came to reveal what humanity was always meant to be.

Every aspect of His life reflected perfect alignment with the Father's will.

He showed the world what happens when a person lives fully connected to God.

The God Factor was visible in every word He spoke and every action He performed.

An Ordinary Beginning

One of the remarkable things about Jesus is how ordinary His earthly beginnings appeared.

He was not born in a palace.

He was born in a manger.

He did not grow up among royalty.

He grew up in a carpenter's home.

He spent most of His early years in relative obscurity.

For thirty years, little is recorded about His public activities.

This reminds us that greatness is not determined by outward appearance.

God often works through ordinary circumstances.

The Son of God entered the world in humility.

His life teaches us that significance is not measured by where we begin.

It is measured by our relationship with God and our obedience to His purpose.

Knowing Who He Was

One reason Jesus lived with such confidence was because He knew who He was.

At His baptism, before He preached a sermon or performed a miracle, the Father declared:

"This is My beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased."
(Matthew 3:17)

Notice the order.

Identity came before ministry.

Relationship came before performance.

Approval came before accomplishment.

Many people spend their lives trying to earn acceptance.

Jesus lived from acceptance.

He knew His identity.

Because He knew who He was, He could not be easily shaken by criticism, rejection, or opposition.

The God Factor begins with understanding who we are in relationship to God.

When identity is secure, life becomes stable.

The Wilderness Test

Immediately after His baptism, Jesus was led into the wilderness.

For forty days He fasted and prayed.

Then the enemy came with temptation.

Interestingly, Satan's attacks focused on identity.

"If You are the Son of God..."

The enemy challenged what God had already declared.

This strategy has not changed.

Satan still attacks identity.

He wants people to question who God says they are.

He wants believers to doubt God's promises.

He wants them to live according to fear instead of faith.

Jesus responded with the Word of God.

Again and again, He answered temptation with truth.

This teaches us an important lesson.

Victory begins with knowing and believing God's Word.

Truth defeats deception.

A Life Connected to the Father

One of the most remarkable aspects of Jesus' ministry was His constant dependence upon the Father.

Although He possessed divine power, He continually emphasized His relationship with God.

He prayed regularly.

He sought the Father's will.

He withdrew from crowds to spend time in communion with God.

Again and again, He declared:

"I do nothing of Myself."

His miracles flowed from relationship.

His wisdom flowed from relationship.

His authority flowed from relationship.

The God Factor is not independent living.

It is dependent living.

True strength comes from connection to God.

Just as a branch cannot bear fruit apart from the vine, people cannot fulfil their highest purpose apart from God.

Authority Over the Natural World

Throughout His ministry, Jesus demonstrated authority that amazed people.

He spoke to storms and they obeyed.

He healed diseases.

He opened blind eyes.

He cleansed lepers.

He multiplied food.

He raised the dead.

These miracles revealed the power of God working through Him.

But they also pointed to something deeper.

Jesus was demonstrating the life God intended humanity to experience—a life connected to heaven.

He was showing what happens when a person lives under God's authority and in partnership with His power.

The miracles were not merely displays of power.

They were demonstrations of God's kingdom.

Seeing What Others Could Not See

Jesus consistently saw beyond appearances.

Where others saw a fisherman, He saw an apostle.

Where others saw a tax collector, He saw a disciple.

Where others saw a sinner, He saw someone worth saving.

Where others saw a persecutor, God later saw the Apostle Paul.

This ability to see potential is part of the God Factor.

God sees people according to purpose.

He sees what they can become through His grace.

Many people define themselves by their past.

God defines them by their future.

Jesus constantly called people higher than their current condition.

Compassion and Power

One of the beautiful balances in Jesus' life was the combination of power and compassion.

He was powerful enough to calm storms.

Yet compassionate enough to notice a blind beggar by the roadside.

He was powerful enough to raise the dead.

Yet compassionate enough to weep at Lazarus' tomb.

He possessed authority without arrogance.

Strength without pride.

Influence without selfishness.

The God Factor is not merely about power.

It is also about character.

God's power is most effective when it flows through a heart shaped by love.

The Ultimate Demonstration

The greatest expression of the God Factor was not a miracle.

It was the cross.

At Calvary, Jesus demonstrated perfect obedience.

He willingly endured suffering for the salvation of humanity.

The cross revealed God's love.

The resurrection revealed God's power.

Together they form the foundation of the Christian faith.

When Jesus rose from the dead, He conquered sin, death, and the grave.

The victory was complete.

The separation caused by sin was overcome.

A way back to relationship with God was opened.

The God Factor became available to all who believe.

The Same Spirit

One of the most astonishing truths in Scripture is found in Romans 8:11:

"But if the Spirit of Him who raised Jesus from the dead dwells in you..."

The same Spirit that empowered Jesus now works in believers.

This does not mean we become Jesus.

It means we are empowered to live the life God has called us to live.

The Christian life was never intended to be lived through human effort alone.

God provides His Spirit.

He gives wisdom.

He provides strength.

He empowers obedience.

He enables believers to fulfil their purpose.

The God Factor is not merely a historical reality.

It is a present reality.

Following His Example

Jesus never called people merely to admire Him.

He called them to follow Him.

To learn from Him.

To walk with Him.

To become more like Him.

This is the goal of spiritual growth.

Not simply gaining knowledge.

Not merely attending services.

But becoming increasingly transformed into the likeness of Christ.

As believers grow in relationship with God, they begin reflecting His character more clearly.

Their thinking changes.

Their priorities change.

Their actions change.

The God Factor becomes increasingly evident in their lives.

The Perfect Example

Every biblical hero points us toward Jesus.

David points us to the King.

Joseph points us to the Saviour rejected by His own.

Moses points us to the Deliverer.

Daniel points us to unwavering faithfulness.

Esther points us to divine purpose.

Yet Jesus surpasses them all.

He is the perfect expression of God's will.

The perfect revelation of God's character.

The perfect demonstration of the God Factor.

In Him we see what life was always meant to be.

Reflection

Jesus did more than teach truth.

He lived it.

He revealed God's original intention for humanity.

He demonstrated what life looks like when lived in complete dependence upon the Father.

His confidence flowed from identity.

His power flowed from relationship.

His authority flowed from obedience.

His influence flowed from love.

The God Factor reaches its fullest expression in Jesus Christ.

As we look to Him, we discover both who God is and who we are called to become.

For the ultimate purpose of life is not merely to know about Jesus.

It is to know Him personally.

To walk with Him daily.

To learn from His example.

And to allow His life to be reflected through our own.

In Jesus, we see the perfect expression of the God Factor.

And through Him, we discover the life God intended for us from the very beginning.

Chapter 13

The Battle for Your Mind

“And do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind...” —
Romans 12:2

If Satan cannot stop you from becoming a believer, he will try to stop you from becoming effective.

If he cannot keep you out of God's family, he will try to keep you from understanding your inheritance.

If he cannot destroy your destiny, he will attempt to confuse your thinking.

Why?

Because he understands a powerful truth:

The way you think determines the way you live.

Your life moves in the direction of your strongest thoughts.

A person who constantly thinks about defeat will often live defeated.

A person who continually expects failure will struggle to pursue success.

A person who believes God's promises will begin living differently.

The battle for your future is often a battle for your mind.

This is why Scripture places such importance on renewing the mind.

The God Factor is not only about changing circumstances.

It is about transforming the way we think.

The Battlefield Within

Many people imagine spiritual warfare as something dramatic and visible.

Yet one of the greatest battlefields is invisible.

It exists within the human mind.

Fear battles faith.

Doubt battles confidence.

Truth battles deception.

Hope battles despair.

Every day people face countless thoughts.

Some bring life.

Others bring destruction.

Not every thought that enters your mind deserves to remain there.

Just because a thought appears does not mean it is true.

Just because a feeling exists does not mean it should control your decisions.

The mind is a gate.

Whatever gains access eventually influences behaviour.

This is why guarding the mind is so important.

The Story of Two Wolves

An elderly man once shared wisdom with his grandson.

He said,

"Inside every person there are two wolves fighting a battle.

One wolf represents fear, anger, jealousy, bitterness, pride, and doubt.

The other wolf represents faith, hope, love, peace, courage, and kindness."

The boy thought for a moment and asked,

"Which wolf wins?"

The old man smiled and replied,

"The one you feed."

The story illustrates an important principle.

Thoughts grow stronger when they receive attention.

Whatever you continually focus upon gains influence.

If you constantly feed fear, fear grows.

If you continually feed faith, faith grows.

The God Factor requires learning to feed the right thoughts.

Israel's Mental Prison

One of the greatest examples of this principle is found in the story of Israel.

God delivered them from Egyptian slavery through mighty miracles.

The Red Sea parted.

The enemy was defeated.

The chains were broken.

Physically, they were free.

Mentally, many remained slaves.

Again and again they doubted.

Again and again they complained.

Again and again they struggled to trust God.

Although they had left Egypt, Egypt had not fully left them.

Their greatest challenge was not crossing the Red Sea.

It was renewing their minds.

Many believers face a similar struggle.

God changes their spiritual position.

Yet their thinking remains trapped in old patterns.

They continue seeing themselves through the lens of fear, failure, and limitation.

Freedom becomes difficult to enjoy when the mind remains imprisoned.

The Stronghold of Wrong Thinking

The Bible speaks about strongholds.

Many imagine strongholds as external forces.

Yet some of the strongest strongholds exist within the mind.

A stronghold is a thought pattern that becomes deeply rooted.

It may begin with a lie.

Over time, that lie becomes a belief.

Eventually, that belief shapes behaviour.

For example:

A child repeatedly hears, "You will never amount to anything."

Years later, the words remain.

The child becomes an adult who fears opportunity.

Not because the statement was true.

But because it became a stronghold.

The enemy often builds prisons out of lies.

The God Factor destroys those prisons with truth.

Gideon's Transformation

When God first spoke to Gideon, He called him a mighty warrior.

Yet Gideon did not see himself that way.

His thinking had been shaped by years of oppression.

His identity had been shaped by fear.

Before Gideon could defeat Midian, he needed a new perspective.

He needed to see himself through God's eyes.

This principle remains true today.

Victory often begins when people replace lies with truth.

The battle changes when thinking changes.

What Are You Thinking About?

One day a teacher filled a glass with muddy water.

The students watched.

The water was dark and cloudy.

The teacher then began pouring clean water into the glass.

Gradually the muddy water overflowed.

Slowly the water became clearer.

Eventually the glass contained only clean water.

The teacher explained:

"The mind works the same way.

You do not overcome wrong thinking by merely wishing it away.

You replace it with truth."

This is why reading God's Word matters.

This is why prayer matters.

This is why worship matters.

The mind is renewed when truth continually flows into it.

Over time, old thinking is pushed out and replaced.

The Mind of Christ

One of the greatest promises in Scripture is found in 1 Corinthians 2:16:

"We have the mind of Christ."

This does not mean believers instantly know everything.

It means they have access to a new way of thinking.

Jesus viewed situations differently.

Where others saw impossibility, He saw opportunity.

Where others saw lack, He saw provision.

Where others saw death, He saw resurrection.

The more believers learn from Christ, the more their thinking begins to align with His.

The God Factor transforms not only actions but perspectives.

David's Different Mind-set

When David faced Goliath, his thinking set him apart.

The soldiers saw danger.

David saw opportunity.

The soldiers focused on the giant's size.

David focused on God's greatness.

The soldiers asked,

"How can anyone defeat him?"

David asked,

"Who is this uncircumcised Philistine that he should defy the armies of the living God?"

The battle was won in David's mind before it was won on the battlefield.

Faith gave him a different perspective.

The God Factor produces a mind-set that views challenges through the lens of God's power rather than human limitations.

Guarding the Gates

Imagine a city without gates.

Anyone could enter.

Anything could enter.

The city would be vulnerable.

The mind functions in a similar way.

What we watch affects our thinking.

What we listen to affects our thinking.

What we read affects our thinking.

The voices we allow into our lives eventually shape our beliefs.

This is why wisdom is necessary.

Not every voice deserves influence.

Not every opinion deserves attention.

Not every message deserves acceptance.

The God Factor requires intentionality.

We must guard the gates of our minds.

Fear Versus Faith

Fear and faith often ask similar questions but arrive at different conclusions.

Fear asks:

"What if everything goes wrong?"

Faith asks:

"What if God comes through?"

Fear focuses on obstacles.

Faith focuses on possibilities.

Fear magnifies problems.

Faith magnifies God.

The difference between fear and faith is not the absence of challenges.

It is the presence of a different perspective.

Daniel saw lions but trusted God.

David saw a giant but trusted God.

Esther saw danger but trusted God.

The God Factor enables believers to view life through faith rather than fear.

The Daily Renewal

Renewing the mind is not a one-time event.

It is a daily process.

Just as the body requires regular nourishment, the mind requires regular renewal.

Every day people choose what they will focus on.

Every day they choose which voices they will believe.

Every day they choose whether fear or faith will dominate their thinking.

Transformation happens gradually.

Thought by thought.

Decision by decision.

Day by day.

As God's truth takes root, thinking changes.

As thinking changes, behaviour changes.

As behaviour changes, destiny unfolds.

A New Lens

Imagine wearing glasses with dirty lenses.

Everything appears distorted.

The problem is not the world.

The problem is the lens.

Many people view life through distorted lenses.

The lens of rejection.

The lens of fear.

The lens of failure.

The lens of insecurity.

The God Factor provides a new lens.

God's truth enables people to see life accurately.

To see opportunities where others see obstacles.

To see purpose where others see confusion.

To see hope where others see despair.

Reflection

The greatest battlefield is often not around us.

It is within us.

Thoughts shape beliefs.

Beliefs shape actions.

Actions shape destiny.

The enemy understands this.

That is why he attacks the mind.

But God has provided truth.

He has provided His Word.

He has provided His Spirit.

He has provided everything necessary for transformation.

The God Factor changes lives by first changing minds.

When people begin thinking according to God's truth, fear loses its influence.

Faith grows stronger.

Purpose becomes clearer.

And life begins moving in the direction God intended.

For the transformation of a life often begins with the transformation of a thought.

And when the mind is renewed, the possibilities become limitless.

Chapter 14

Living Above the Natural

***“For we walk by faith, not by sight.” — 2
Corinthians 5:7***

One of the greatest differences between a believer and an unbeliever is not the challenges they face.

Both encounter difficulties.

Both experience disappointments.

Both face uncertainty.

Both live in the same world.

The difference lies in how they see life.

One lives according to what can be seen.

The other learns to live according to what God has said.

One is controlled by circumstances.

The other is guided by faith.

This is what it means to live above the natural.

It does not mean ignoring reality.

It means recognizing that there is a greater reality beyond what human eyes can see.

The God Factor enables ordinary people to rise above natural limitations and live from a heavenly perspective.

More Than What the Eyes Can See

Human beings naturally depend upon their senses.

We trust what we see.

We believe what we hear.

We respond to what we feel.

Yet some of life's greatest realities cannot be seen.

Love cannot be seen.

Hope cannot be seen.

Faith cannot be seen.

God cannot be seen with natural eyes.

Yet all these realities are powerful.

The visible world is not the only world.

Behind what can be seen lies a spiritual reality.

Throughout Scripture, God continually called His people to look beyond appearances.

He invited them to trust Him even when circumstances suggested otherwise.

The God Factor begins when people understand that what is visible is not always final.

Abraham and the Impossible Promise

Abraham provides one of the greatest examples of living above the natural.

God promised him a son.

The promise seemed simple.

The problem was that Abraham and Sarah were advanced in age.

From a natural perspective, the situation appeared impossible.

Years passed.

The promise remained unfulfilled.

Everything visible suggested failure.

Yet Abraham chose faith.

Romans 4:19-20 tells us:

"And not being weak in faith, he did not consider his own body, already dead... He did not waver at the promise of God through unbelief, but was strengthened in faith."

Abraham learned to place greater confidence in God's promise than in natural circumstances.

Eventually the impossible became possible.

Isaac was born.

The promise was fulfilled.

Faith enabled Abraham to live beyond what the natural world declared.

Seeing Through God's Eyes

A man once entered a room filled with beautiful paintings.

As he walked around, he criticized every picture.

"The colours are wrong."

"The images are distorted."

"The artist made mistakes."

An attendant listened quietly before pointing out the problem.

The paintings were fine.

The man's glasses were dirty.

After cleaning them, everything looked different.

The paintings had not changed.

His perspective had.

Many people view life through dirty lenses.

The lens of fear.

The lens of doubt.

The lens of failure.

The lens of past disappointments.

As a result, they misinterpret what they see.

Faith cleans the lens.

It enables people to view circumstances through God's perspective.

The God Factor changes not only what we believe but also how we see.

Elisha's Servant

One morning, Elisha's servant woke up to a frightening sight.

An enemy army had surrounded the city.

Horses.

Chariots.

Soldiers.

Everywhere he looked, danger appeared.

Terrified, he ran to Elisha.

"Alas, my master! What shall we do?" (2 Kings 6:15)

Elisha's response was remarkable.

"Do not fear, for those who are with us are more than those who are with them."

The servant must have been confused.

The enemy army was clearly visible.

Where were these additional forces?

Then Elisha prayed:

"Lord, open his eyes that he may see."

Suddenly the servant saw something he had never noticed before.

The mountains were filled with heavenly horses and chariots of fire.

The situation had not changed.

What changed was his vision.

Many believers need the same prayer.

Not necessarily for changed circumstances.

But for opened eyes.

The God Factor enables people to recognize that God's resources are greater than visible challenges.

Faith Is Not Denial

Some people misunderstand faith.

They assume faith means pretending problems do not exist.

It does not.

David acknowledged the giant.

Daniel acknowledged the lions.

Esther acknowledged the danger.

Jesus acknowledged the cross.

Faith is not denial.

Faith simply refuses to give problems the final word.

Faith recognizes reality but chooses to trust God's power above it.

The God Factor does not ignore challenges.

It confronts them with confidence in God.

Walking on Water

One of the most fascinating miracles in Scripture occurred when Jesus walked on water.

The disciples were caught in a storm.

Waves crashed against the boat.

Fear filled their hearts.

Then they saw Jesus approaching.

Peter responded with unusual boldness.

"Lord, if it is You, command me to come to You on the water."

Jesus replied,

"Come."

Peter stepped out of the boat.

For a brief moment, he did something impossible.

He walked on water.

What changed?

His focus.

As long as Peter focused on Jesus, he remained above the natural limitations of his environment.

When he shifted his attention to the wind and waves, fear returned.

He began to sink.

The lesson remains powerful.

Faith rises when focus remains on God.

Fear grows when focus remains on circumstances.

The Limitation of Human Strength

One of life's greatest lessons is recognizing the limits of human ability.

No amount of education can guarantee wisdom.

No amount of wealth can guarantee peace.

No amount of influence can guarantee fulfilment.

Human strength has limits.

God does not.

The God Factor begins where human effort reaches its boundaries.

This does not mean believers stop working.

It means they stop depending solely on themselves.

They learn to trust God's strength in addition to their own efforts.

They recognize that success ultimately flows from God's blessing.

Eagles and Storms

Eagles possess a unique ability.

When storms approach, most birds seek shelter.

The eagle responds differently.

Instead of fleeing the storm, it uses the storm.

Strong winds lift the eagle higher.

The very thing that troubles other birds becomes an advantage.

Many believers spend their lives trying to avoid every challenge.

Yet God often uses challenges to elevate them.

Joseph's prison prepared him for leadership.

David's giant prepared him for kingship.

Daniel's lions revealed God's power.

The storm that seems designed to destroy you may become the very thing God uses to lift you higher.

The God Factor transforms obstacles into opportunities.

The Supernatural Lifestyle

Living above the natural does not require spectacular miracles every day.

It begins with simple trust.

Trusting God when answers are not obvious.

Trusting God when resources seem limited.

Trusting God when circumstances are uncertain.

Trusting God when fear would prefer retreat.

The supernatural life is not reserved for a few special individuals.

It is the normal result of walking closely with God.

Every act of faith invites God's involvement.

Every step of obedience creates room for His power.

The God Factor becomes visible wherever people trust God more than their circumstances.

Heaven's Perspective

One day, two people may look at the same situation and reach completely different conclusions.

One sees impossibility.

The other sees opportunity.

One sees lack.

The other sees provision.

One sees defeat.

The other sees victory.

The difference is perspective.

The first sees only the natural.

The second sees through the lens of faith.

This is how David viewed Goliath.

This is how Joseph viewed prison.

This is how Daniel viewed Babylon.

This is how Esther viewed her assignment.

And this is how Jesus viewed the cross.

Faith sees beyond the present moment.

It sees God's purpose.

The God Factor in Everyday Life

Many people associate faith only with dramatic moments.

Yet the God Factor is meant to influence everyday life.

It affects decisions.

It affects relationships.

It affects work.

It affects leadership.

It affects how we respond to challenges.

Living above the natural means inviting God into every area of life.

It means recognizing His presence in ordinary moments.

It means trusting Him in both major decisions and daily responsibilities.

The God Factor is not merely for crises.

It is a lifestyle.

Reflection

The natural world constantly tells people to depend only on what they can see.

God calls His people to walk by faith.

Faith does not ignore reality.

It simply recognizes a greater reality.

The reality of God's promises.

The reality of God's power.

The reality of God's presence.

Throughout Scripture, ordinary people accomplished extraordinary things because they learned to live above the natural.

They trusted God when circumstances seemed impossible.

They believed His promises when evidence appeared contrary.

And God proved Himself faithful.

The God Factor invites every believer into the same journey.

A journey of faith.

A journey of trust.

A journey of seeing life from heaven's perspective.

For those who learn to walk by faith discover that God's possibilities are always greater than human limitations.

And when God becomes the centre of life, the impossible becomes the stage upon which His power is revealed.

Chapter 15

Awakening the Giant Within

“Now to Him who is able to do exceedingly abundantly above all that we ask or think, according to the power that works in us.” — Ephesians 3:20

Every person enters this world carrying potential.

Within every child is a future not yet revealed.

Within every dream is a possibility waiting to be explored.

Within every believer is a God-given purpose waiting to be awakened.

Yet many people go through life without ever discovering what God placed within them.

They live below their potential.

They settle for less than God's purpose.

They allow fear, doubt, and circumstances to keep them from becoming who they were created to be.

The tragedy is not that they lacked ability.

The tragedy is that they never discovered it.

The final lesson of the God Factor is this:

There is more in you than you realize.

Not because of who you are alone.

But because of who God is within you.

The Sleeping Giant

There is a story about a powerful giant who fell into a deep sleep.

As years passed, people built houses around him.

Children played nearby.

Entire communities developed in his shadow.

Generation after generation lived without realizing what lay beneath them.

Then one day the giant awakened.

The ground shook.

The people were astonished.

What had appeared ordinary suddenly revealed extraordinary power.

Many believers are like that sleeping giant.

They carry gifts they have never developed.

Dreams they have never pursued.

Potential they have never explored.

The power of God is present within them, yet much of it remains dormant.

The God Factor awakens people to the reality of what God has placed inside them.

Discovering Your Assignment

One of the most important moments in life occurs when a person discovers their assignment.

Not everyone has the same assignment.

David was called to lead a nation.

Joseph was called to preserve nations during famine.

Daniel was called to influence governments.

Esther was called to save her people.

The disciples were called to spread the Gospel.

Each assignment was different.

But every assignment mattered.

The same is true today.

Some are called to ministry.

Some are called to business.

Some are called to education.

Some are called to leadership.

Some are called to raise godly families.

Some are called to serve quietly behind the scenes.

The assignment may differ, but the source remains the same.

God is the one who calls.

The God Factor helps people discover and embrace their unique purpose.

The Danger of Unused Potential

A wealthy man once owned a large piece of land.

After his death, the property was inherited by relatives who knew very little about it.

For decades they struggled financially.

They worked hard merely to survive.

Unknown to them, valuable minerals lay beneath the soil.

The wealth had always been there.

The problem was ignorance.

One day geologists surveyed the property and discovered the hidden resources.

Everything changed.

The family became prosperous, not because something new had been added, but because something valuable had been discovered.

Many believers live the same way.

They spend years unaware of what God has placed within them.

The gifts are there.

The calling is there.

The purpose is there.

The potential is there.

The challenge is discovering it.

The Power of Purpose

Purpose gives meaning to life.

Without purpose, people drift.

With purpose, they endure.

Purpose enabled Joseph to survive prison.

Purpose enabled Moses to confront Pharaoh.

Purpose enabled Esther to risk her life.

Purpose enabled Paul to endure persecution.

People who know why they are alive can endure difficulties that would overwhelm others.

Purpose acts like a compass.

It provides direction during uncertain seasons.

It keeps people moving forward when obstacles arise.

The God Factor awakens purpose and transforms ordinary existence into meaningful living.

The Seed Principle

Every seed contains more than what is visible.

Within a tiny seed lies a future tree.

Branches.

Leaves.

Fruit.

Shade.

Growth.

Everything is hidden within the seed.

Yet none of it becomes visible unless the seed is planted.

Potential alone is not enough.

Potential must be developed.

Many people admire successful individuals while overlooking the process that produced success.

Growth requires commitment.

Development requires effort.

Purpose requires action.

The God Factor reveals potential, but it also calls people to cultivate it.

Breaking the Chains of Limitation

One of the greatest obstacles to purpose is limitation.

Not necessarily physical limitations.

Mental limitations.

Spiritual limitations.

Emotional limitations.

Many people carry invisible chains.

Chains formed by fear.

Chains formed by failure.

Chains formed by negative experiences.

Chains formed by the opinions of others.

The enemy works tirelessly to convince people that they cannot become what God says they can become.

The God Factor breaks those chains.

It reminds people that their future is not determined by their past.

Their destiny is not limited by their history.

God's purpose is greater than their failures.

God's power is greater than their weaknesses.

The Story of the Mountain Climber

A group of climbers once attempted to reach the summit of a great mountain.

The climb was difficult.

The weather was harsh.

Many turned back.

As the climbers struggled upward, voices from below shouted:

"It cannot be done!"

"The mountain is too high!"

"You will never make it!"

One by one, people abandoned the climb.

Eventually only one climber reached the summit.

When he returned, people asked how he had succeeded when everyone else failed.

The answer surprised them.

The climber was deaf.

He never heard the voices telling him it was impossible.

Many people never reach their purpose because they listen to the wrong voices.

The God Factor teaches us to listen to God's voice above every other voice.

His opinion matters most.

His promises matter most.

His purpose matters most.

The Power Within

One of the most remarkable truths in Scripture is that God's Spirit lives within believers.

The same Spirit that empowered biblical heroes continues to work today.

This means believers are never alone.

They are not limited to human strength.

They have access to divine help.

God provides wisdom.

God provides strength.

God provides guidance.

God provides courage.

The God Factor is not merely about what people can do for God.

It is about what God can do through people who trust Him.

Leaving a Legacy

A meaningful life is not measured merely by personal success.

It is measured by impact.

The question is not simply:

"What did I accomplish?"

The greater question is:

"Whose life became better because I lived?"

Jesus left a legacy.

The apostles left a legacy.

David left a legacy.

Daniel left a legacy.

Esther left a legacy.

Their influence extended beyond their lifetimes.

The same opportunity exists for every believer.

Purpose always points beyond self.

It seeks to serve.

To bless.

To influence.

To leave the world better than it was found.

The God Factor transforms people into instruments of lasting impact.

The Call to Rise

Throughout this book we have encountered individuals from different backgrounds and generations.

A shepherd.

A prisoner.

A fugitive.

A farmer.

An exile.

An orphan.

A carpenter from Nazareth.

Their circumstances differed.

Their personalities differed.

Their assignments differed.

Yet they shared one thing in common.

They discovered the God Factor.

They discovered that God was greater than their fears.

Greater than their limitations.

Greater than their circumstances.

And because they discovered God, they discovered themselves.

The same invitation remains today.

God is still calling people to rise.

To trust Him.

To embrace their purpose.

To walk by faith.

To fulfil their assignment.

The question is whether they will respond.

The Greatest Discovery

At the beginning of this book, we considered one of life's greatest questions:

Who am I?

The answer is found not merely by looking inward.

It is found by looking upward.

The more people know God, the more they discover who they truly are.

Identity flows from relationship.

Purpose flows from identity.

Impact flows from purpose.

The greatest discovery in life is not discovering wealth.

Not discovering fame.

Not discovering success.

The greatest discovery is discovering God and who you are because of Him.

That discovery changes everything.

Reflection

You were not created merely to survive.

You were created to fulfil a purpose.

You were not created merely to exist.

You were created to make an impact.

You were not created to live controlled by fear.

You were created to walk by faith.

The God Factor is the awareness that God's life, purpose, and power are available to those who know Him.

It is the realization that you are more than your circumstances.

More than your past.

More than your limitations.

The same God who empowered David, Joseph, Moses, Gideon, Daniel, Esther, and the apostles is still at work today.

And He is still calling ordinary people to do extraordinary things.

The giant within is not human greatness.

It is the greatness of God working through a surrendered life.

Awaken to that reality.

Embrace your purpose.

Walk in faith.

Know your God.

And step boldly into the destiny for which you were created.

For when the God Factor becomes alive in a person's heart, there is no limit to what God can accomplish through them.

Conclusion

The Greatest Discovery

The journey of this book began with a simple truth:

Man was formed from the dust of the earth, but animated by the breath of God.

You are not merely natural.

You carry the imprint of your Creator.

The greatest discovery of your life is not discovering what is in the world.

It is discovering who God is and who you are because of Him.

David discovered it and faced giants.

Joseph discovered it and survived prisons.

Moses discovered it and delivered a nation.

Daniel discovered it and influenced kingdoms.

Esther discovered it and changed history.

Jesus demonstrated it perfectly.

Now the invitation is yours.

Know your God.

Discover your purpose.

Awaken the God Factor.

And become everything God created you to be.

For those who know their God shall be strong, and carry out great exploits.

The End

By D. Ngure

GracePath Network

DISCOVER THE GOD FACTOR

Ordinary People, Extraordinary God. Unlimited Possibilities.

The God Factor is more than a book—it's an invitation to experience the supernatural power of God in your everyday life. Through the lives of biblical heroes, you'll discover timeless truths that will strengthen your faith, renew your mind, and awaken the purpose within you.

IN THIS BOOK, YOU WILL DISCOVER:

- ★ How God transforms ordinary people into instruments of His purpose.
- ★ The keys to living by faith and not by sight.
- ★ How to overcome fear, doubt, and limitations with God's power.
- ★ Your divine assignment and the importance of fulfilling it.
- ★ How to awaken the giant within and step into your God-given destiny.



This is more than inspiration—this is *transformation*. As you apply these life-changing principles, you will experience the God Factor in your home, your work, your relationships, and your future.

God is ready. Are you?



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NETWORK**

INSPIRING FAITH. IGNITING PURPOSE.
IMPACTING GENERATIONS.



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*"For those who know their God shall be strong,
and carry out great exploits."*

— Daniel 11:32